# Physics and Mathematics Reference

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## 1 Physical system overview

The audited execution graph models three coupled analysis layers.

1. A MATLAB heating model evaluates a discrete operating grid for a resistive nichrome coil inside a heater tube, followed by an aeration-tube network embedded in the vermicomposter bed `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L1172-L1677`; `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L1803-L2248`.
2. A Python summer branch replaces the electrical heater with a spot-cooled plenum and assist blower, then reuses the same reduced-order aeration, evaporation, and two-node bed closures with a blower/system operating-point correction when the requested flow exceeds the available assist-blower static `heat_transfer_study.py:L2760-L3378`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L4326-L4438`.
3. A Python annual layer reuses the selected heating and cooling reference points against a representative-year ambient driver `heat_transfer_study.py:L4547-L5012`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L5013-L5496`.

The physically important paths are electrical Joule heating of the wire, wire-to-air convection, heater-shell loss to ambient, sensible air-to-bed transfer through the aeration tube wall, direct discharge enthalpy through the perforations, latent heat consumption by evaporation, and bed-to-ambient loss through the vessel wall and top boundary condition.

This document is intentionally more explicit than `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex`. It restates the implemented equation families, identifies where they appear in the repository narrative, and records the exact code locations where each block is implemented or approximated.

## 2 Modeling boundaries and scope

- MATLAB is the authoritative source of the winter/heating operating-point grid and geometry-driven heater calculations `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L1172-L1677`.
- Python is authoritative for the final reported heating recommendation, the full summer cooling workflow, the annual layer, and the current text summaries and plots `heat_transfer_study.py:L2220-L2499`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L2534-L3292`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L5013-L7020`.
- The model is reduced-order. Tubes are one-dimensional marching domains; the bed is a two-node lumped thermal network; plume and habitat calculations are post-processing estimates rather than CFD `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L1803-L2248`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L1062-L1595`.

- The summer branch reuses the same bin wall, aeration-tube, evaporation, and two-node closures, but replaces electrical heating with spot-cooled inlet air and an assist-blower operating-point closure `heat_transfer_study.py:L2760-L3378`.
- This reference documents only equations actually found in the repository. Where `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex` contains broader narrative or optional transient discussion not used by the rooted execution graph, that is called out explicitly.

# 3 Modeling assumptions

- Air is treated as an ideal gas with Sutherland-law viscosity and fixed $c_p$ and $Pr$ in the property package `heat_transfer_study.py:L3607-L3675`; `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L2333-L2359`.
- Heater and aeration tubes are discretized axially and solved by explicit marching rather than simultaneous PDE solution `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L1803-L1999`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L2707-L2959`.
- Parallel aeration branches are identical at a given operating point. Total heat, water loss, and power are assembled from per-tube or per-string contributions `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L1497-L1677`.
- The bed is represented by bottom and top thermal nodes with a single internal conductance between them `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L971-L1075`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L4326-L4438`.
- Evaporation is represented as a local latent sink limited by diffusion, carrying capacity, and available sensible heat; there is no resolved liquid transport field in the compost `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L2000-L2122`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L2567-L2603`.
- The vented-cover top is a repository-specific mixed boundary condition: insulated cover over most of the top plus free convection over a small vent area `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L971-L1075`; `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L785-L847`.
- Summer spot-cooler behavior is a surrogate model based on configured rated quantities and simple psychrometric limiting, not a first-principles vapor-compression cycle model `heat_transfer_study.py:L2605-L2705`.

# 4 Energy balances

## 4.1 Air and psychrometric property package

Dry-air density is evaluated as

$$\rho = \frac{p}{RT}. \tag{1}$$

Dynamic viscosity uses the Sutherland form

$$\mu = \mu_0 \left(\frac{T}{T_0}\right)^{3/2} \frac{T_0 + S}{T + S}. \tag{2}$$

Thermal conductivity is then reconstructed from

$$k = \frac{\mu c_p}{Pr}. \tag{3}$$

For the summer psychrometric branch, humidity ratio is computed from vapor partial pressure $p_v$ as

$$w = 0.62198 \frac{p_v}{p - p_v}, \tag{4}$$

and, for a given relative humidity $\phi$,

$$p_v = \phi\, p_{\mathrm{sat}}(T). \tag{5}$$

Here $p_{\mathrm{sat}}(T)$ denotes the pure-water saturation pressure used by the implemented humid-air algebra. In the Python summer branch, that saturation-pressure call, the dew-point inversion built on it, and the latent-heat calls used later in the evaporation section are all routed through the imported `IAPWS_95.py` backend; the detailed Wagner–Pruss form is developed later in the moisture section.

**Type.** Equation (1) is exact for the ideal-gas approximation adopted here; (2) is a fitted transport-property relation; (3) is a derived closure using fixed $c_p$ and $Pr$; (4)–(5) are exact algebraic psychrometric relations for the implemented moisture basis.
**Repository-native narrative.** `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L11-L37`; `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L1089-L1235`; `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L2084-L2245`.
**Implementation.** `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L2333-L2359`; `IAPWS_95.py:L614-L674`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L3946-L4003`.
**Deviation note.** The property package uses constant $c_p$ and $Pr$ rather than temperature-dependent tabulated humid-air properties.

### 4.2 Tube-flow partitions, perforations, and electrical grouping

Let the total imposed inlet volumetric flow be $\dot{V}_{\mathrm{tot}}$ and the number of parallel aeration branches be $N_{\mathrm{tubes}}$. The per-tube inlet volumetric flow is

$$\dot{V}_{\mathrm{tube,in}} = \frac{\dot{V}_{\mathrm{tot}}}{N_{\mathrm{tubes}}}. \tag{6}$$

Using the inlet density $\rho_{\mathrm{in}}$, the corresponding per-tube inlet mass flow is

$$\dot{m}_{\mathrm{tube,in}} = \rho_{\mathrm{in}} \dot{V}_{\mathrm{tube,in}}. \tag{7}$$

For an aeration tube discretized into $N_{\mathrm{aer}}$ axial segments with $N_h$ perforation holes of diameter $d_h$,

$$A_h = \frac{\pi d_h^2}{4}, \qquad A_{h,\mathrm{tube}} = N_h A_h, \qquad A_{h,\mathrm{seg}} = \frac{N_h}{N_{\mathrm{aer}}} A_h, \tag{8}$$

Following the general orifice discharge relation compiled by Idel'chik ([R12], pp. 31–32 of the accessible English translation), the closed-end aeration-tube model treats the segmentwise released mass flow as

$$\dot{m}_{\mathrm{rel},i} = C_d A_{h,\mathrm{seg}} \sqrt{2\rho_i \Delta p_i}, \qquad \Delta p_i = \max(p_{\mathrm{tube},i} - p_{\mathrm{bed},i}, 0)\,. \tag{9}$$

Here $p_{\mathrm{bed},i}$ is the local bed-side gauge pressure returned by the segmentwise porous-bed backpressure closure in Section 5. Because $p_{\mathrm{bed},i}$ itself depends on $\dot{m}_{\mathrm{rel},i}$ through that Ergun-based closure, (9) is an implicit local scalar relation rather than a one-shot explicit discharge evaluation. The corresponding segment release fraction is therefore an output,

$$\phi_{\mathrm{rel},i} = \frac{\dot{m}_{\mathrm{rel},i}}{\dot{m}_{\mathrm{tube,in}}}, \qquad \sum_{i=1}^{N_{\mathrm{aer}}} \phi_{\mathrm{rel},i} = 1, \tag{10}$$

where the unity sum follows from the same steady closed-end mass balance used later in the axial march: the segment update is $\dot{m}_{\mathrm{rem},i+1} = \dot{m}_{\mathrm{rem},i} - \dot{m}_{\mathrm{rel},i}$ with $\dot{m}_{\mathrm{rem},1} = \dot{m}_{\mathrm{tube,in}}$, and the inlet gauge pressure is chosen so that the terminal residual at the cap satisfies $\dot{m}_{\mathrm{rem},N_{\mathrm{aer}}+1} \approx 0$. Therefore

$$\sum_{i=1}^{N_{\mathrm{aer}}} \dot{m}_{\mathrm{rel},i} = \dot{m}_{\mathrm{tube,in}} - \dot{m}_{\mathrm{rem},N_{\mathrm{aer}}+1} \approx \dot{m}_{\mathrm{tube,in}},$$

so $\sum_i \phi_{\mathrm{rel},i} = 1$ holds to the mass-balance tolerance of the closed-end shooting solve rather than by an independent ad hoc normalization. Operationally, for a prescribed $\dot{m}_{\mathrm{tube,in}}$, the code solves these fractions by a scalar shooting method on inlet gauge pressure. It begins from a whole-hole-area estimate

$$p_{\mathrm{in,hi}} \sim \frac{1}{2\rho_{\mathrm{ref}}} \left( \frac{\dot{m}_{\mathrm{tube,in}}}{C_d A_{h,\mathrm{tot}}} \right)^2,$$

then marches the tube segment by segment at that trial pressure. In segment $i$, it solves the implicit local release equation (9) together with the porous-bed backpressure closure by bounded scalar bisection on $\dot{m}_{\mathrm{rel},i} \in [0, \dot{m}_{\mathrm{rem},i}]$, updates $\dot{m}_{\mathrm{rem},i+1}$, computes the local friction drop, and reduces the downstream tube pressure before moving to the next segment. After the last segment, the scalar residual for the trial inlet pressure is the remaining axial flow $\dot{m}_{\mathrm{rem},N_{\mathrm{aer}}+1}$. If that residual is still too large, the upper pressure bound is doubled until a bracket is found, and the code then bisects on inlet gauge pressure to find the smallest value for which

$$\dot{m}_{\mathrm{rem},N_{\mathrm{aer}}+1} \leq \max\left(10^{-9},\, 10^{-4}\dot{m}_{\mathrm{tube,in}}\right).$$

The converged segmentwise releases $\dot{m}_{\mathrm{rel},i}$ from that final marched state are then reported as $\phi_{\mathrm{rel},i} = \dot{m}_{\mathrm{rel},i}/\dot{m}_{\mathrm{tube,in}}$. and the local mean perforation-exit velocity is

$$u_{h,i} = \frac{\dot{V}_{\mathrm{rel},i}}{A_{h,\mathrm{seg}}}. \tag{11}$$

The coil helix geometry is built from the mean coil diameter $D_{\mathrm{mean}}$, pitch $p$, and axial coil span $L_{\mathrm{coil}}$. The per-turn length is

$$L_{\mathrm{turn}} = \sqrt{(\pi D_{\mathrm{mean}})^2 + p^2}, \tag{12}$$

and the wire length is

$$L_{\mathrm{wire}} = N_{\mathrm{turns}} L_{\mathrm{turn}}, \qquad N_{\mathrm{turns}} \approx \frac{L_{\mathrm{coil}}}{p}. \tag{13}$$

With wire resistivity $\rho_{\mathrm{wire}}(T)$ and cross-sectional area $A_{\mathrm{wire}}$,

$$R_{\mathrm{tube}} = \rho_{\mathrm{wire}}(T_{\mathrm{avg}}) \frac{L_{\mathrm{wire}}}{A_{\mathrm{wire}}}. \tag{14}$$

The current heating implementation does not assume that every heater tube is wired directly in parallel. Instead, each electrical *string* is one current path made by wiring one or more identical heater tubes in series, and the supply sees several such strings in parallel. A *group* is the subset of strings that all have the same number of series-connected tubes, so they share the same current and per-tube power calculation. For group $g$, let $n_{s,g}$ be the number of tubes in series in each string, and let $n_{\mathrm{str},g}$ be the number of parallel strings having that same series count. For example, 8 total

tubes default to four identical 2-tube strings, written $4 \times 2\mathrm{S}$; 7 total tubes default to one 3-tube string in parallel with two 2-tube strings, written $1 \times 3\mathrm{S} + 2 \times 2\mathrm{S}$. Then

$$I_{\mathrm{tube},g} = \frac{V}{n_{s,g} R_{\mathrm{tube}}}, \tag{15}$$

$$P_{\mathrm{tube},g} = I_{\mathrm{tube},g}^2 R_{\mathrm{tube}}, \tag{16}$$

and with $n_{\mathrm{tubes},g} = n_{s,g} n_{\mathrm{str},g}$,

$$I_{\mathrm{tot}} = \sum_g n_{\mathrm{str},g} I_{\mathrm{tube},g}, \qquad P_{\mathrm{tot}} = \sum_g n_{\mathrm{tubes},g} P_{\mathrm{tube},g}. \tag{17}$$

The heater-tube air inlet is the greenhouse ambient state,

$$T_{\mathrm{air,in}} = T_\infty, \tag{18}$$

and the aeration-tube inlet is the heater-tube outlet,

$$T_{\mathrm{air,in,aer}} = T_{\mathrm{air,out,heater}}. \tag{19}$$

For any uninsulated tube of outer diameter $D_o$, the outside perimeter used to convert an axial length to an external heat-transfer area is

$$P_{\mathrm{tube,out}} = \pi D_o, \qquad A_{\mathrm{seg,out}} = P_{\mathrm{tube,out}} \Delta x. \tag{20}$$

**Type.** Equations (6), (7), (8), (10), and (20) are exact algebraic bookkeeping relations on the reduced-order model state. Equation (9) is the adopted closed-end perforation discharge closure based on [R12], pp. 31–32, coupled to the segmentwise Ergun bed-backpressure closure introduced later in Section 5.
**Repository-native narrative.** The same physical quantities appear in `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L961-L1034`, `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L1560-L1738`, and `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L2302-L2444`.
**Implementation.** `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L763-L875`; `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L1497-L1677`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L3895-L3924`; `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L1684-L1727`.
**Deviation note.** The MATLAB implementation permits mixed string sizes for odd tube counts; the equations above are therefore written in grouped summation form rather than assuming a single equivalent series-parallel pattern.

### 4.3 Heater-tube energy balance

With heater length $L_{\mathrm{heater}}$ discretized into $N_{\mathrm{heater}}$ segments,

$$\Delta x_{\mathrm{heater}} = \frac{L_{\mathrm{heater}}}{N_{\mathrm{heater}}}, \tag{21}$$

and the local generated electrical heat assigned to segment $i$ is

$$q_{\mathrm{gen},i} = P_{\mathrm{branch}} \frac{\Delta x_{\mathrm{heater}}}{L_{\mathrm{heater}}}. \tag{22}$$

For heater segment $i$, the air-energy update is

$$T_{\mathrm{air},i+1} = T_{\mathrm{air},i} + \frac{q_{\mathrm{gen},i} - q_{\mathrm{loss},i}}{\dot{m} c_p}. \tag{23}$$

Wire temperature is then recovered from the local wire-to-air temperature rise

$$\Delta T_{\mathrm{wire},i} = \frac{q_{\mathrm{gen},i}}{h_{\mathrm{wire},i} A'_{\mathrm{wire}} \Delta x}, \qquad T_{\mathrm{wire},i} = T_{\mathrm{air},i} + \Delta T_{\mathrm{wire},i}. \tag{24}$$

The coefficients appearing in (24) and (25) are evaluated locally as

$$h_{\mathrm{wire},i} = M_{\mathrm{wire}} \frac{Nu_{\mathrm{wire},i} k_i}{D_{\mathrm{wire}}}, \qquad h_{\mathrm{inside,heater},i} = M_{\mathrm{wall}} \frac{Nu_{\mathrm{heater},i} k_i}{D_i}, \qquad h_{\mathrm{outside,heater}} = h_{\mathrm{heater,ext,cfg}},$$

$$U_{\mathrm{heater}} = \left( \frac{D_{\mathrm{ext}}}{D_i h_{\mathrm{inside,heater},i}} + \frac{D_{\mathrm{ext}}}{2k_{\mathrm{wall}}} \ln\left(\frac{D_o}{D_i}\right) + \frac{D_{\mathrm{ext}}}{2k_{\mathrm{ins}}} \ln\left(\frac{D_{\mathrm{ext}}}{D_o}\right) + \frac{1}{h_{\mathrm{outside,heater}}} \right)^{-1}, \qquad P_{\mathrm{heater,ext}} = \pi D_{\mathrm{ext}},$$

with $Nu_{\mathrm{wire},i}$ from (91) and $Nu_{\mathrm{heater},i}$ from the internal-tube correlation branch in Section 6. In repository notation, $M_{\mathrm{wire}} \equiv$ `model_overrides.calibration.hWireMultiplier`, $M_{\mathrm{wall}} \equiv$ `model_overrides.calibration.hWallMultiplier`, and $h_{\mathrm{heater,ext,cfg}} \equiv$ `heaterTube.externalH_W_m2K`; the current JSON defaults set both multipliers to 1.0 and $h_{\mathrm{heater,ext,cfg}} = 10\,\mathrm{W/m^2/K}$. Thus $h_{\mathrm{wire},i}$ and $h_{\mathrm{inside,heater},i}$ are correlation-derived local coefficients, while $h_{\mathrm{outside,heater}}$ is *not* re-derived from a separate Nusselt closure in the present implementation. Instead, the model prescribes

$$h_{\mathrm{outside,heater}} = h_{\mathrm{heater,ext,cfg}},$$

as a constant effective ambient-side heater-shell coefficient representing the combined external natural-convection and any small-scale exterior losses around the insulated heater tube. The current default is $10\,\mathrm{W/m^2/K}$. The segmentwise heater-shell loss is

$$q_{\mathrm{loss},i} = U_{\mathrm{heater}} P_{\mathrm{heater,ext}} \Delta x_{\mathrm{heater}} \left(T_{\mathrm{air},i} - T_\infty\right). \tag{25}$$

**Type.** Equation (22) is exact segment bookkeeping on the reduced model. Equation (23) is a discretized one-dimensional steady energy balance. Equations (24) and (25) are reduced-order algebraic temperature-drop and shell-loss closures.
**Repository-native narrative.** `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L38-L121`.
**Implementation.** `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L1803-L1894`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L3775-L3895`.
**Deviation note.** The wire-to-air temperature difference is represented by a direct convective drop rather than a resolved wire conduction model.

### 4.4 Aeration-tube segment balance

With aeration length $L_{\mathrm{aer}}$ discretized into $N_{\mathrm{aer}}$ segments,

$$\Delta x_{\mathrm{aer}} = \frac{L_{\mathrm{aer}}}{N_{\mathrm{aer}}}, \tag{26}$$

with the remaining in-tube mass flow marched by

$$\dot{m}_{\mathrm{rem},i+1} = \dot{m}_{\mathrm{rem},i} - \dot{m}_{\mathrm{rel},i}, \qquad \dot{m}_{\mathrm{rem},1} = \dot{m}_{\mathrm{tube,in}}, \qquad \dot{m}_{\mathrm{rem},N_{\mathrm{aer}}+1} = 0. \tag{27}$$

The inlet gauge pressure is the value for which the coupled perforation-discharge march (9) and axial tube-friction march satisfy the terminal closed-end condition above. The mean throughflow carried by segment $i$ is

$$\dot{m}_{\mathrm{mean},i} = \dot{m}_{\mathrm{rem},i} - \frac{1}{2}\dot{m}_{\mathrm{rel},i}. \tag{28}$$

This is the arithmetic average of the segment-inlet and segment-outlet axial throughflows,

$$\dot{m}_{\mathrm{mean},i} = \frac{\dot{m}_{\mathrm{rem},i} + \dot{m}_{\mathrm{rem},i+1}}{2},$$

obtained by substituting (27). The model uses that midpoint flow as the segment-average air heat-capacity rate for the wall-exchange step, which is why it appears in the exponential wall factor (36) and in $q_{\mathrm{wall},i}$. Using the segment average is a reduced-order approximation to continuously decreasing axial flow within a perforated segment: the inlet flow would overestimate the retained stream's thermal capacity over the whole segment, while the outlet flow would underestimate it. Thus the model does *not* force the last segment's axial throughflow to zero. Rather, the final segment may still carry a nonzero inlet and mean throughflow while releasing the remaining mass, and the zero-flow condition applies only to the post-segment residual $\dot{m}_{\mathrm{rem},N_{\mathrm{aer}}+1}$ at the closed cap. This discrete closure is physically consistent provided the final modeled segment truly extends to the sealed end and contains the last active sidewall perforations near that sealed end. The end cap itself is not assumed to be perforated. Under that geometry, the final segment can legitimately carry nonzero axial flow while its released side flux drives the downstream residual to zero at the cap. If the real hardware instead includes an unperforated dead-end tail after the last perforation row, that tail should be modeled as an additional no-release terminal section; otherwise the present discretization lumps too much distal release directly against the cap and overcompresses the true near-tip pressure and release profile. The pressure-side closure for the same aeration march, including the local tube-to-bed driving pressure, the segment friction update, the reported branch pressure requirement, the distribution-network losses, and the full heating/cooling total pressure-drop assemblies, is consolidated in Section 5. For aeration segment $i$, the net bed-side energy contribution is

$$q_{\mathrm{bed},i} = q_{\mathrm{wall},i} + q_{\mathrm{jet},i} - q_{\mathrm{evap},i}. \tag{29}$$

Here $q_{\mathrm{wall},i}$ is the wall-mediated sensible exchange with the bed, $q_{\mathrm{jet},i}$ is the direct released-air enthalpy term, and $q_{\mathrm{evap},i}$ is the latent sink associated with the selected evaporation rate. The wall and release-temperature closures are introduced immediately below in this subsection; the evaporation closure is developed later in the moisture section. Summing over the segment set gives

$$Q_{\mathrm{bed,branch}} = \sum_i q_{\mathrm{bed},i}, \tag{30}$$

and the total bed heat rate across $N_{\mathrm{tubes}}$ identical branches is

$$Q_{\mathrm{bed,total}} = N_{\mathrm{tubes}} Q_{\mathrm{bed,branch}}. \tag{31}$$

The coefficients appearing in the wall-exchange factor are evaluated locally as

$$h_{\mathrm{inside,aer},i} = M_{\mathrm{wall}} \frac{Nu_{\mathrm{aer},i} k_i}{D_i}, \qquad h_{\mathrm{outside,aer}} = M_{\mathrm{bed}} h_{\mathrm{bed,cfg}}, \qquad P_{\mathrm{aer,out}} = \pi D_o,$$

$$U_{\mathrm{aer}} = \left( \frac{D_o}{D_i h_{\mathrm{inside,aer},i}} + \frac{D_o}{2k_{\mathrm{wall}}} \ln\left(\frac{D_o}{D_i}\right) + \frac{1}{h_{\mathrm{outside,aer}}} \right)^{-1},$$

with $Nu_{\mathrm{aer},i}$ from the internal-tube correlation branch in Section 6, $M_{\mathrm{wall}} \equiv$ `model_overrides.calibration.hWallM`, $M_{\mathrm{bed}} \equiv$ `model_overrides.calibration.bedHTMultiplier`, and $h_{\mathrm{bed,cfg}} \equiv$ `aeration.bedH_W_m2K`. Thus $h_{\mathrm{inside,aer},i}$ is correlation-derived from the internal-tube Nusselt relation, whereas $h_{\mathrm{outside,aer}}$ is not presently obtained from a separate porous-bed or buried-cylinder convection correlation. Instead, the implementation prescribes

$$h_{\mathrm{outside,aer}} = M_{\mathrm{bed}} h_{\mathrm{bed,cfg}},$$

with $h_{\mathrm{bed,cfg}}$ treated as a constant effective bed-side coefficient representing the combined external sensible transport from the tube wall into the surrounding bed. The current default is $h_{\mathrm{bed,cfg}} = 8.0\,\mathrm{W/m^2/K}$ with $M_{\mathrm{bed}} = 1.0$. Both current rooted branches apply the same wall exchange through an exponential segment factor,

$$\frac{d}{dx}\left[\dot{m}_{\mathrm{mean},i} c_p \left(T - T_{\mathrm{bed,ref}}\right)\right] = -U_{\mathrm{aer}} P_{\mathrm{aer,out}} \left(T - T_{\mathrm{bed,ref}}\right), \tag{32}$$

which is the standard one-dimensional segment energy balance for a plug-flow air stream exchanging heat with a local bed-side temperature reservoir $T_{\mathrm{bed,ref}}$ through the overall conductance $U_{\mathrm{aer}} P_{\mathrm{aer,out}}$. Over one discrete segment, the implementation holds $\dot{m}_{\mathrm{mean},i}$, $c_p$, $U_{\mathrm{aer}}$, and $T_{\mathrm{bed,ref}}$ constant, so integrating (32) over $\Delta x_{\mathrm{aer}}$ gives

$$\frac{d(T - T_{\mathrm{bed,ref}})}{T - T_{\mathrm{bed,ref}}} = -\frac{U_{\mathrm{aer}} P_{\mathrm{aer,out}}}{\dot{m}_{\mathrm{mean},i} c_p}\, dx, \tag{33}$$

and therefore, from the segment inlet $x = 0$ with $T = T_{\mathrm{air},i}$ to the segment outlet $x = \Delta x_{\mathrm{aer}}$ with $T = T_{\mathrm{air,after\,wall},i}$,

$$\int_{T_{\mathrm{air},i} - T_{\mathrm{bed,ref}}}^{T_{\mathrm{air,after\,wall},i} - T_{\mathrm{bed,ref}}} \frac{d\theta}{\theta} = -\int_0^{\Delta x_{\mathrm{aer}}} \frac{U_{\mathrm{aer}} P_{\mathrm{aer,out}}}{\dot{m}_{\mathrm{mean},i} c_p}\, dx = -\frac{U_{\mathrm{aer}} P_{\mathrm{aer,out}} \Delta x_{\mathrm{aer}}}{\dot{m}_{\mathrm{mean},i} c_p}, \tag{34}$$

so that

$$\ln\left(\frac{T_{\mathrm{air,after\,wall},i} - T_{\mathrm{bed,ref}}}{T_{\mathrm{air},i} - T_{\mathrm{bed,ref}}}\right) = -\frac{U_{\mathrm{aer}} P_{\mathrm{aer,out}} \Delta x_{\mathrm{aer}}}{\dot{m}_{\mathrm{mean},i} c_p}. \tag{35}$$

Applying the exponential function to both sides of (35) then gives the segment decay factor. This is not a separate fitted relation; it is the direct algebraic solution of the standard first-order constant-property wall-exchange balance represented by (32), consistent with the generic heat-transfer treatment cited in [R5].

$$\Theta_i = \exp\left[-\frac{U_{\mathrm{aer}} P_{\mathrm{aer,out}} \Delta x_{\mathrm{aer}}}{\dot{m}_{\mathrm{mean},i} c_p}\right], \tag{36}$$

$$\frac{T_{\mathrm{air,after\,wall},i} - T_{\mathrm{bed,ref}}}{T_{\mathrm{air},i} - T_{\mathrm{bed,ref}}} = \Theta_i, \tag{37}$$

so $\Theta_i$ is literally the fraction of the segment-inlet temperature excess above $T_{\mathrm{bed,ref}}$ that remains after wall exchange across one aeration segment. Values near 1 indicate weak decay over that segment, whereas values near 0 indicate strong relaxation of the retained tube air toward the bed-side reference temperature.

$$T_{\mathrm{air,after\,wall},i} = T_{\mathrm{bed,ref}} + \left(T_{\mathrm{air},i} - T_{\mathrm{bed,ref}}\right)\Theta_i, \tag{38}$$

This quantity is therefore a *derived segment-outlet retained-air temperature*, not a separate state that stores the inside-convection, wall-conduction, and outside-transfer contributions individually.

Those mechanisms enter only through the upstream definition of $U_{\text{aer}}$ and hence through $\Theta_i$; once (38) is evaluated, $T_{\text{air,after wall},i}$ is just the resulting outlet temperature of the retained tube air. and the retained in-tube air state is marched to the next aeration segment by

$$T_{\text{air},i+1} = T_{\text{air,after wall},i}. \tag{39}$$

with

$$q_{\text{wall},i} = \dot{m}_{\text{mean},i} c_p \left(T_{\text{air},i} - T_{\text{air,after wall},i}\right). \tag{40}$$

The discharge-enthalpy term uses the segment-average release temperature

$$T_{\text{rel},i} = \frac{T_{\text{air},i} + T_{\text{air,after wall},i}}{2}. \tag{41}$$

**Type.** Derived reduced-order balance.
**Repository-native narrative.** `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L151-L205`; `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L1586-L1609`; `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L2168-L2238`.
**Implementation.** `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L1895-L2076`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L2987-L3277`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L4182-L4323`.
**Deviation note.** The model treats released-air sensible exchange as a lumped enthalpy source rather than resolving jets in the pore space. The inlet gauge pressure is obtained by scalar shooting/bisection, so the terminal condition $\dot{m}_{\text{rem},N_{\text{aer}}+1} = 0$ is satisfied to numerical tolerance rather than by closed-form inversion.

### 4.5 Two-node bed balance

Here $T_b$ and $T_t$ are the bottom-node and top-node bed temperatures, respectively; $T_\infty$ is the ambient air temperature; $Q_b$ and $Q_t$ are the net bed heat inputs assigned to the bottom and top nodes; $UA_{b,\infty}$ and $UA_{t,\infty}$ are the bottom-to-ambient and top-to-ambient conductances; and $UA_{12}$ is the internal conductance coupling the two bed nodes. The split factor $f_b$ assigns a fraction of the total bed heat rate $Q_{\text{bed,total}}$ to the bottom node. The bottom and top bed nodes are solved from the steady $2 \times 2$ linear system

$$\begin{bmatrix} UA_{b,\infty} + UA_{12} & -UA_{12} \\ -UA_{12} & UA_{t,\infty} + UA_{12} \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} T_b \\ T_t \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} Q_b + UA_{b,\infty} T_\infty \\ Q_t + UA_{t,\infty} T_\infty \end{bmatrix}, \tag{42}$$

with

$$Q_b = f_b Q_{\text{bed,total}}, \qquad Q_t = (1 - f_b) Q_{\text{bed,total}}. \tag{43}$$

In variable-role terms, $T_b$ and $T_t$ are the dependent unknown node temperatures solved from the linear system. The ambient temperature $T_\infty$, the total bed heat rate $Q_{\text{bed,total}}$, the split factor $f_b$, and the conductances $UA_{b,\infty}$, $UA_{t,\infty}$, and $UA_{12}$ are treated as known inputs for the current operating point. The quantities $Q_b$ and $Q_t$ are therefore not additional unknowns; they are derived forcing terms assembled from $Q_{\text{bed,total}}$ and $f_b$.

Physically, (42) enforces steady energy balance on two lumped bed control volumes. The bottom node exchanges heat with ambient through $UA_{b,\infty}$, exchanges heat with the top node through $UA_{12}$, and receives the assigned bed load $Q_b$. The top node does the analogous thing with $UA_{t,\infty}$, $UA_{12}$, and $Q_t$. The diagonal terms in the matrix collect heat leakage out of each node, the off-diagonal terms represent internal node-to-node coupling, and the right-hand side collects the externally imposed heating/cooling plus the ambient forcing.

Numerically, this is solved as a direct dense $2 \times 2$ linear solve, not by iteration: MATLAB uses left division $A \backslash b$, and Python uses `np.linalg.solve`. In the rooted heating path and in the annual layer, that direct solve is the entire bed-temperature step once the conductances and $Q_{\text{bed,total}}$ are known. In the summer cooling branch, the same direct two-node solve is nested inside an outer scalar fixed-point/bisection closure for the bed reference temperature, but the inner two-node kernel itself remains this direct algebraic solve.

**Type.** Derived algebraic reduction of a two-node thermal network.
**Repository-native narrative.** `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L365-L424`; `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L2010-L2079`.
**Implementation.** `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L2233-L2248`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L4432-L4438`.
**Deviation note.** The current rooted execution path does not use the optional transient MATLAB PID simulation; the authoritative audit path is the steady algebraic solve above.

# 5 Fluid mechanics, pressure-loss assumptions, and pressure-drop model

This section consolidates the fluid-mechanical assumptions and the exact pressure-drop quantities reported by the current code.

**Fluid-mechanical assumptions used by the pressure-loss and aeration-discharge model.**

- Internal passages are treated as smooth circular tubes. Tube friction is represented by Darcy–Weisbach pressure loss with $64/Re$ in laminar flow and Churchill's explicit smooth-tube relation otherwise, and abrupt area changes are represented by standard minor-loss coefficients rather than resolved separation or secondary-flow models.
- Flow is not treated with a full compressible momentum formulation. The code does update local density from the ideal-gas relation using the local temperature and pressure state, but the friction, minor-loss, and perforation-discharge closures are all used in their incompressible-form reduced-order versions.
- The optional upstream header loss and the unresolved internal splitter/manifold loss are represented by textbook fitting-loss surrogates from the Crowl–Louvar 2-$K$ method.
- Parallel aeration branches are assumed identical at a given operating point, so one representative closed-end perforated branch is marched axially and then scaled up.
- Perforations are smeared uniformly over the configured segment count rather than resolved hole by hole. The end cap itself is not perforated.
- When an open top or top vent is present, the bed-side pressure opposing perforation discharge is derived segmentwise from a reduced-order Ergun porous-bed escape model leading to the open top or nearest vent. If no such ambient-side opening exists, the current code falls back to the configured bed-side boundary gauge pressure.
- The porous-bed closure is still reduced-order: it uses one representative tube-center height and one tributary top area per tube segment rather than a full three-dimensional porous-bed or headspace-flow network.
- The marched tube gauge pressure is not allowed to fall below the local bed-side gauge pressure used for that segment, so the reduced-order march does not permit reversal of the intended discharge direction.

All pressures in the aeration branch march are written on a gauge basis unless explicitly noted

otherwise. Let $p_{\text{tube},i}$ denote the local tube gauge pressure at the inlet of aeration segment $i$, let $p_{\text{out,offset}}$ denote the configured outlet-boundary gauge-pressure offset supplied through `bedSideGaugePressure_Pa`, let $p_{\text{out,bnd}}$ denote the outlet-boundary gauge pressure at the end of the porous escape path, let $p_{\text{bed},i}$ denote the local bed-side gauge pressure predicted for segment $i$, and let $p_{\text{in,gauge}}$ denote the aeration-branch inlet gauge pressure returned by the closed-end shooting solve. Here $p_{\text{out,bnd}}$ is the pressure at the top opening or vent outlet reached by the porous escape path, not the pressure adjacent to the tube wall. For one branch assigned an equal share of $N_{\text{vent}}$ identical circular top vents of diameter $D_{\text{vent}}$, the total branch-share vent area is

$$A_{\text{vent,branch}} = \frac{N_{\text{vent}} \pi D_{\text{vent}}^2}{4 N_{\text{tubes}}}. \tag{44}$$

By definition, the outlet-boundary gauge pressure $p_{\text{out,bnd}}$ is

$$p_{\text{out,bnd}} = \begin{cases} p_{\text{out,offset}}, & \text{open top,} \\ p_{\text{out,offset}} + \dfrac{1}{2\rho_{\text{out}}} \left( \dfrac{\dot{m}_{\text{tube,in}}}{C_{d,\text{vent}} A_{\text{vent,branch}}} \right)^2, & \text{covered top plus vents,} \\ p_{\text{out,offset}}, & \text{no explicit top opening modeled.} \end{cases} \tag{45}$$

Here $C_{d,\text{vent}} = 0.63$ is the simple-hole discharge coefficient implied by the Crowl–Louvar entrance-plus-exit loss treatment for a hole, for which they note $\sum K_f = 1.5$ and therefore $C_d \approx 0.63$ from equation (4-40) [R14, p. 126]. The boundary density $\rho_{\text{out}}$ is evaluated with the same air-property package used elsewhere in the branch march, at the current bed-reference temperature and ambient absolute pressure $p_\infty$. Thus an open top uses a direct atmospheric boundary up to the configured gauge offset, a covered vented top adds a Crowl–Louvar vent-hole discharge backpressure, and a fully closed-top case still falls back to the configured offset because no outlet geometry is available from which to derive a separate top-side discharge loss. Under the repository default $p_{\text{out,offset}} = 0\,\text{Pa}$ gauge, the open-top case therefore corresponds to an atmospheric boundary. The local absolute pressure used for property evaluation is

$$p_{\text{abs},i} = p_\infty + \max(p_{\text{tube},i}, p_{\text{out,bnd}}), \tag{46}$$

where $p_\infty$ is the ambient absolute pressure. For the distribution network, $u_{\text{header}}$ is the mean velocity in the upstream header, $u_{\text{conn}}$ is the mean velocity in the branch connector, $D_{\text{header}}$ is the header inside diameter, $D_{\text{split,in}}$ is the splitter-inlet inside diameter, $D_{\text{conn}}$ is the branch-connector inside diameter, $D_{\text{down}}$ is the downstream branch-tube diameter seen by the connector-to-branch transition, and $L_{\text{conn}}$ is the branch-connector length. Because the Crowl–Louvar 2-$K$ fitting method is tabulated on an inch basis while the present document is written in SI units, use

$$1\ \text{in} = 0.0254\ \text{m}, \qquad D_{\text{in}} = \frac{D}{0.0254}, \qquad D_{\text{conn,in}} = \frac{D_{\text{conn}}}{0.0254},$$

when inserting SI diameters into the 2-$K$ formulas below. The connector friction factor $f_{\text{conn}}$ is the Churchill friction factor evaluated at the connector Reynolds number

$$Re_{\text{conn}} = \frac{\rho u_{\text{conn}} D_{\text{conn}}}{\mu}.$$

If a header is present, it is the shared upstream passage between the blower outlet and the splitter inlet; if no distinct common passage exists there, the model sets `headerEnabled=false` and omits the header term entirely.

The code constructs Reynolds number in the standard form

$$Re = \frac{\rho u D}{\mu}. \tag{47}$$

For laminar internal flow, the Darcy friction factor is

$$f = \frac{64}{Re}. \tag{48}$$

For turbulent internal flow, the implemented smooth-tube Churchill expression is

$$A = \left[2.457 \ln\left(\frac{1}{(7/Re)^{0.9}}\right)\right]^{16}, \qquad B = \left(\frac{37530}{Re}\right)^{16}, \tag{49}$$

$$f = 8\left[\left(\frac{8}{Re}\right)^{12} + \frac{1}{(A+B)^{3/2}}\right]^{1/12}. \tag{50}$$

Tube friction losses are accumulated with Darcy–Weisbach:

$$\Delta p_f = f \frac{L}{D} \frac{\rho u^2}{2}. \tag{51}$$

For the reduced-order porous escape model surrounding one representative aeration branch, let the filled bed height be

$$H_{\text{fill}} = H_{\text{bin}} f_{\text{fill}}, \tag{52}$$

where $H_{\text{bin}}$ is the bin interior height and $f_{\text{fill}}$ is the filled-volume fraction. In this porous-escape geometry, $x$ denotes the axial coordinate measured from the upstream aeration-tube inlet toward the closed end, and $y$ denotes the vertical coordinate measured upward from the bin floor. The index $i = 1, \ldots, N_{\text{aer}}$ enumerates the uniformly discretized aeration segments, so with $\Delta x_{\text{aer}} = L_{\text{aer}}/N_{\text{aer}}$ the segment-center location is derived directly from the midpoint of segment $i$. The quantity $y_{\text{tube,rep}}$ is not a solved axial profile; it is the one representative tube-center height used by the reduced-order porous-bed closure for all segments. If the user supplies `representativeTubeCenterHeight_m`, the code uses that value directly. Otherwise it defaults to a heuristic representative height of $0.10 H_{\text{fill}}$, clamped so the tube center remains at least one tube radius above the bin floor and one tube radius below the filled top surface.

Let the tributary top area assigned to one tube segment be

$$A_{\text{bed,trib}} = \frac{W_{\text{bin}} \Delta x_{\text{aer}}}{N_{\text{tubes}}}, \qquad x_i = \left(i - \frac{1}{2}\right) \Delta x_{\text{aer}}. \tag{53}$$

This tributary area is derived from an equal-strip allocation: each segment is assigned a bed strip of axial length $\Delta x_{\text{aer}}$, full bin width $W_{\text{bin}}$, and one-$N_{\text{tubes}}$ share of that top area because the parallel aeration tubes are assumed hydraulically identical in the present reduced-order closure. If the top is open, the porous escape length for each segment is taken as the vertical distance to the filled top surface,

$$L_{\text{bed},i} = H_{\text{fill}} - y_{\text{tube,rep}}. \tag{54}$$

If the top is covered but vented with $N_{\text{vent}}$ equal vents assumed evenly spaced over the aeration length $L_{\text{aer}}$, then the vent-center locations are

$$x_{\text{vent},j} = \left(j - \frac{1}{2}\right) \frac{L_{\text{aer}}}{N_{\text{vent}}}, \tag{55}$$

where $j = 1, \ldots, N_{\text{vent}}$ is simply the vent index. The present model does not solve vent positions from geometry data; it derives them from the simplifying assumption that $N_{\text{vent}}$ identical vents are evenly spaced over the covered aeration length $L_{\text{aer}}$. and the porous escape length for segment $i$ is approximated by the straight-line distance to the nearest vent center,

$$L_{\text{bed},i} = \sqrt{(H_{\text{fill}} - y_{\text{tube,rep}})^2 + \left(\min_j |x_i - x_{\text{vent},j}|\right)^2}. \tag{56}$$

The local superficial bed velocity associated with one segment release is then

$$u_{\text{bed},i} = \frac{\dot{m}_{\text{rel},i}}{\rho_i A_{\text{bed,trib}}}, \tag{57}$$

which is obtained directly from continuity on the porous-bed side using the released mass flow $\dot{m}_{\text{rel},i}$, the segment-$i$ air density $\rho_i$, and the tributary bed area $A_{\text{bed,trib}}$. The present model uses this as a *superficial* velocity, meaning it is based on the total assigned cross-sectional bed area rather than on only the void area. It is therefore the standard Ergun velocity scale; the corresponding interstitial pore velocity would be $u_{\text{bed},i}/\varepsilon$, but that is not the quantity inserted into the current closure. and the segmentwise Ergun pressure gradient is

$$\frac{\Delta p_{\text{Ergun},i}}{L_{\text{bed},i}} = 150\frac{(1-\varepsilon)^2}{\varepsilon^3}\frac{\mu_i u_{\text{bed},i}}{d_p^2} + 1.75\frac{1-\varepsilon}{\varepsilon^3}\frac{\rho_i u_{\text{bed},i}^2}{d_p}, \tag{58}$$

where $\varepsilon$ is the bed porosity (void fraction) used by the porous-flow closure. In the current repository, the default value is held constant at

$$\varepsilon = \frac{0.801 + 0.799}{2} = 0.800,$$

taken as the arithmetic mean of the Table 2 pre-composting total-porosity values at COM day 21 and day 63, which bracket the repository's nominal 30-day pre-composting window [R16, Table 2, p. 299]. The present reduced-order model keeps that porosity constant rather than evolving it in time because the same source shows only weak variation during the combined composting-plus-vermicomposting process: in the C + V data, total porosity changes from 79.9 to 81.0% v/v between day 63 and day 203, a spread of only 1.1 percentage points over 140 days [R16, Table 2, p. 299]. A user override remains available through `bedPorosity` if later material-specific measurements are preferred. The local $\rho_i$ and $\mu_i$ are the segment-$i$ air density and viscosity returned by the same local air-property package used elsewhere in the branch march. The quantity $d_p$ is the representative particle diameter used by the porous-flow closure. In the current repository, if no explicit `bedParticleDiameter_m` override is supplied, the Ergun model defaults to

$$d_p = d_{32},$$

reusing the same Table 3 Sauter mean diameter defined later by (111) for the particle-surface wetted-area estimate so that the porous-flow and surface-area submodels share the same default particle-size basis. A separate override remains available if later hydraulic calibration indicates that the effective porous-flow diameter should differ from the surface-area diameter. The code then takes the local bed-side gauge pressure as

$$p_{\text{bed},i} = p_{\text{out,bnd}} + \Delta p_{\text{Ergun},i}. \tag{59}$$

If no open top or top vent is present, the present reduced-order implementation does not define a separate ambient-side porous escape path and therefore falls back to

$$p_{\mathrm{bed},i} = p_{\mathrm{out,offset}}.$$

For the closed-end aeration branch, the local pressure difference driving perforation discharge is

$$\Delta p_i = \max(p_{\mathrm{tube},i} - p_{\mathrm{bed},i}, 0)\,, \tag{60}$$

so the local release law (9) is evaluated on that tube-to-bed pressure difference. The explicit Darcy friction drop marched across aeration segment $i$ is

$$\Delta p_{\mathrm{seg},i} = f_i \frac{\Delta x_{\mathrm{aer}}}{D_{\mathrm{aer}}} \frac{\rho_i u_i^2}{2}, \tag{61}$$

with axial pressure update

$$p_{\mathrm{tube},i+1} = \max(p_{\mathrm{tube},i} - \Delta p_{\mathrm{seg},i},\, p_{\mathrm{bed},i})\,, \qquad p_{\mathrm{tube},1} = p_{\mathrm{in,gauge}}. \tag{62}$$

The accumulated explicit tube-friction contribution is therefore

$$\Delta p_{\mathrm{tube,fric}} = \sum_{i=1}^{N_{\mathrm{aer}}} \Delta p_{\mathrm{seg},i}. \tag{63}$$

This quantity is the accumulated explicit friction *drop*, not a local tube-pressure state. The local tube gauge pressure at segment $i$ is $p_{\mathrm{tube},i}$, whereas the cumulative friction drop up to that location may be written

$$\Delta p^{(i)}_{\mathrm{tube,fric}} = \sum_{k=1}^{i-1} \Delta p_{\mathrm{seg},k}. \tag{64}$$

If the bed-pressure floor in (62) never activates, then

$$p_{\mathrm{tube},i} = p_{\mathrm{in,gauge}} - \Delta p^{(i)}_{\mathrm{tube,fric}}. \tag{65}$$

More generally, $p_{\mathrm{in,gauge}} - p_{\mathrm{tube},i}$ is the realized cumulative drop to that location, while $\Delta p_{\mathrm{tube,fric}}$ denotes only the explicit Darcy friction contribution summed over the aeration segments. The reported aeration-branch pressure requirement is the inlet gauge pressure returned by the closed-end discharge-plus-friction shooting solve,

$$\Delta p_{\mathrm{aer,reported}} = p_{\mathrm{in,gauge}}, \tag{66}$$

rather than $\Delta p_{\mathrm{tube,fric}}$ alone. Under the default open-top and zero-offset configuration, $p_{\mathrm{out,bnd}} = 0$ and this reported quantity is the branch pressure drop from the aeration inlet to the atmospheric outlet boundary seen by the porous escape path. Abrupt expansion is modeled as

$$\zeta_{\mathrm{exp}} = \left(1 - \frac{A_1}{A_2}\right)^2, \qquad \Delta p_{\mathrm{exp}} = \zeta_{\mathrm{exp}} \frac{\rho u_1^2}{2}. \tag{67}$$

Here $A_1$ and $A_2$ are the upstream and downstream cross-sectional areas of the local area change, and $u_1$ is the upstream mean velocity. This is the Idel'chik Section IV sudden-expansion coefficient

written on the upstream-velocity basis and is algebraically the same Borda–Carnot form [R6, p. 112]. For a conical contraction from the larger area $A_1$ to the smaller area $A_2$, let

$$\epsilon = \frac{A_2}{A_1},$$

and let $\theta$ denote the included cone angle. The conical contraction surrogate uses the Idel'chik Section III bellmouth relation, equation (3-3), with the coefficient $C(\epsilon, \theta)$ interpolated from the "conical converging bellmouth without end wall" chart (Diagram 3-5) [R12, pp. 82–85], and applies

$$\zeta_{\text{contr}} = C(\epsilon, \theta)\left(\frac{1}{\epsilon} - 1\right), \qquad \Delta p_{\text{contr}} = \zeta_{\text{contr}} \frac{\rho u_2^2}{2}. \tag{68}$$

Here $u_2$ is the mean velocity in the smaller downstream passage. Whenever the text later writes a shorthand such as

$$\Delta p_{\text{contr}}(\dot{m}, D_1, D_2, \theta),$$

it means: evaluate (68) for a contraction carrying mass flow $\dot{m}$ from upstream diameter $D_1$ to downstream diameter $D_2$ at cone angle $\theta$, with

$$A_1 = \frac{\pi D_1^2}{4}, \qquad A_2 = \frac{\pi D_2^2}{4}, \qquad \epsilon = \frac{A_2}{A_1}, \qquad u_2 = \frac{4\dot{m}}{\rho \pi D_2^2}.$$

Likewise, the shorthand

$$\Delta p_{\text{exp}}(\dot{m}, D_1, D_2)$$

means: evaluate (67) for an abrupt expansion carrying mass flow $\dot{m}$ from upstream diameter $D_1$ to downstream diameter $D_2$, with

$$A_1 = \frac{\pi D_1^2}{4}, \qquad A_2 = \frac{\pi D_2^2}{4}, \qquad u_1 = \frac{4\dot{m}}{\rho \pi D_1^2}.$$

These are only compact notational shorthands for repeated use of the already defined minor-loss relations; they are not separate empirical formulas.

Following the Crowl–Louvar presentation of Hooper's 2-$K$ method [R14, pp. 124–126], the fitting-loss coefficient for a resolved fitting is

$$K_f = \frac{K_1}{Re} + K_\infty\left(1 + \frac{1}{D_{\text{in}}}\right), \tag{69}$$

where $D_{\text{in}}$ is the flow-path inside diameter expressed in inches. For entrances and exits, Crowl and Louvar modify that relation to

$$K_{\text{entr/exit}} = \frac{K_1}{Re} + K_\infty. \tag{70}$$

In the present repository, the optional upstream-header term is idealized as a normal entrance into the separate header, so the code uses

$$K_{\text{header}} = \frac{160}{Re_{\text{header}}} + 0.50, \qquad Re_{\text{header}} = \frac{\rho u_{\text{header}} D_{\text{header}}}{\mu}. \tag{71}$$

Crowl and Louvar list these normal-entrance constants immediately below equation (4-39), stating $K_1 = 160$ and $K_\infty = 0.50$ for a normal entrance [R14, p. 126]. If `headerEnabled=false`, the model omits that header term entirely.

The commercial 4-way shutoff manifold does not publish an internal hydraulic-loss model, so one branch path through the splitter body is approximated as a standard threaded tee used as an elbow followed by one full-line open gate/ball/plug valve, both on the connector basis from Table 4-2 [R14, p. 125]:

$$K_{\text{tee,branch}} = \frac{500}{Re_{\text{conn}}} + 0.70\left(1 + \frac{1}{D_{\text{conn,in}}}\right), \tag{72}$$

$$K_{\text{valve,full}} = \frac{300}{Re_{\text{conn}}} + 0.10\left(1 + \frac{1}{D_{\text{conn,in}}}\right), \tag{73}$$

and therefore

$$K_{\text{splitter,body}} = K_{\text{tee,branch}} + K_{\text{valve,full}} \tag{74}$$

This remains a hardware surrogate because the manifold's actual internal geometry is unresolved, but it is now tied to explicit textbook fitting rows rather than to an arbitrary user-specified lumped $K$.

The individual distribution-network components reported by the code are all optional in the sense that they appear only when the corresponding geometric element exists in the modeled distribution path. Thus:

- $\Delta p_{\text{header}}$ appears only when a separate upstream header is enabled.
- $\Delta p_{\text{header}\to\text{splitter}}$ appears only when that separate header exists and contracts into the splitter inlet.
- $\Delta p_{\text{splitter}}$ appears only when flow passes through the splitter/manifold body.
- $\Delta p_{\text{connector,fric}}$ appears only when $L_{\text{conn}} > 0$.
- $\Delta p_{\text{connector}\to\text{branch}}$ appears only when the downstream branch-tube diameter differs from the connector diameter.

Written individually, these contributions are

$$\Delta p_{\text{header}} = K_{\text{header}} \frac{\rho u_{\text{header}}^2}{2}, \tag{75}$$

$$\Delta p_{\text{header}\to\text{splitter}} = \Delta p_{\text{contr}}(\dot{m}_{\text{split}}, D_{\text{header}}, D_{\text{split,in}}, \theta_{\text{cone}}), \tag{76}$$

$$\Delta p_{\text{splitter}} = K_{\text{splitter,body}} \frac{\rho u_{\text{conn}}^2}{2}, \tag{77}$$

$$\Delta p_{\text{connector,fric}} = f_{\text{conn}} \frac{L_{\text{conn}}}{D_{\text{conn}}} \frac{\rho u_{\text{conn}}^2}{2}, \tag{78}$$

and

$$\Delta p_{\text{connector}\to\text{branch}} = \begin{cases} \Delta p_{\text{contr}}(\dot{m}_{\text{branch}}, D_{\text{conn}}, D_{\text{down}}, \theta_{\text{cone}}), & D_{\text{down}} < D_{\text{conn}}, \\ \Delta p_{\text{exp}}(\dot{m}_{\text{branch}}, D_{\text{conn}}, D_{\text{down}}), & D_{\text{down}} > D_{\text{conn}}, \\ 0, & D_{\text{down}} = D_{\text{conn}}. \end{cases} \tag{79}$$

Here $\dot{m}_{\text{split}}$ is the mass flow entering the splitter inlet, $\dot{m}_{\text{branch}}$ is the mass flow in one representative branch connector, and $\theta_{\text{cone}}$ is the configured included contraction-cone angle used in the Idel'chik contraction surrogate. The total distribution-network loss is the sum of whichever of these optional terms are active for the chosen geometry and configuration:

$$\Delta p_{\text{dist}} = \Delta p_{\text{header}} + \Delta p_{\text{header}\to\text{splitter}} + \Delta p_{\text{splitter}} + \Delta p_{\text{connector,fric}} + \Delta p_{\text{connector}\to\text{branch}}. \tag{80}$$

For the summer cooling branch, the exact reported total is

$$\Delta p_{\text{tot,cool}} = \Delta p_{\text{aer,reported}} + \Delta p_{\text{dist}}. \tag{81}$$

For heating electrical-topology group $g$, the smooth heater-tube wall-friction contribution is

$$\Delta p_{\text{heater},g} = \sum_j f_j \frac{\Delta x_{\text{heater}}}{D_{\text{heater}}} \frac{\rho_j u_j^2}{2}, \tag{82}$$

where $j$ indexes the heater-tube marching segments within one representative branch of group $g$. Equation (82) is therefore the discrete Darcy–Weisbach sum for the smooth heater tube itself: it accounts only for the pressure consumed by wall friction while pushing the branch flow through the heated internal tube, with $\rho_j$, $u_j$, and $f_j$ allowed to vary from segment to segment as the air is warmed.

The helical wire is represented separately by the reduced-order obstruction term

$$\Delta p_{\text{coil},g} = \sum_j M_{\text{coil}} C_{D,\text{coil}} \frac{\rho_j u_{\perp,j}^2}{2} \left( \frac{a_{\text{proj}}}{A_{\text{tube}}} \right) \Delta x_{\text{heater}}, \tag{83}$$

with

$$u_{\perp,j} = \chi_{\text{helix}} |u_j|, \qquad \chi_{\text{helix}} = \frac{\pi D_{\text{coil}}}{\sqrt{(\pi D_{\text{coil}})^2 + p_{\text{helix}}^2}}, \qquad a_{\text{proj}} = \frac{\pi D_{\text{coil}} d_{\text{wire}}}{p_{\text{helix}}}, \tag{84}$$

and $A_{\text{tube}} = \pi D_{\text{heater}}^2/4$. Here $D_{\text{coil}}$ is the coil mean diameter, $d_{\text{wire}}$ is the wire diameter, $p_{\text{helix}}$ is the axial pitch, $a_{\text{proj}}$ is the wire projected frontal area per unit heater length, $\chi_{\text{helix}}$ is the code's helix-angle factor, $C_{D,\text{coil}} \equiv$ `heaterTube.coilDragCoefficient`, and $M_{\text{coil}} \equiv$ `heaterTube.coilLossMultiplier`. Equation (83) is therefore a repository-specific reduced-order surrogate, not a direct transcription of one handbook chart: it maps the qualitative resistance increase shown for "Tubes with wire ribbing" in Section VIII (printed p. 337 of the consulted scan; PDF file page 346) and "Spiral-ribbed air heater" in Section XII, Diagram 12-21 (printed p. 482; PDF file page 491) into a segmentwise projected-area drag model [R17]. If the coil model is disabled or the wire geometry is invalid, the implementation sets $\Delta p_{\text{coil},g} = 0$. The active JSON configuration exposes this closure through `coilPressureModel`, `coilDragCoefficient`, and `coilLossMultiplier` under `model_overrides.heaterTube`. Because both (82) and (83) are evaluated segmentwise at the group's own diverted flow, the resulting $\rho_j$, $u_j$, and $u_{\perp,j}$ already reflect the density and velocity changes induced by heating and by any redistributed branch flow.

The branch expansion loss from the heater tube into the larger aeration tube is

$$\Delta p_{\text{exp},g} = \Delta p_{\text{exp}}(\dot{m}_g, D_{\text{heater}}, D_{\text{aer}}),$$

i.e. the heater-to-aeration sudden expansion from (67) evaluated at the redistributed group flow $\dot{m}_g$. Let $\Delta p_{\text{dist,private},g}$ denote the branch-private distribution contribution after the shared header path, i.e.

$$\Delta p_{\text{dist,private},g} = \Delta p_{\text{splitter},g} + \Delta p_{\text{connector},g} + \Delta p_{\text{connector}\to\text{branch},g}.$$

The exact branch-path total for group $g$ is then

$$\Delta p_{\text{branch},g} = \Delta p_{\text{dist,private},g} + \Delta p_{\text{heater},g} + \Delta p_{\text{coil},g} + \Delta p_{\text{exp},g} + \Delta p_{\text{aer,reported},g}. \tag{85}$$

Equation (85) is the full series-path sum for one representative branch of group $g$: the same fluid packet first traverses the branch-private splitter/connector hardware, then the heater tube and

helical obstruction, then the heater-to-aeration expansion, then the closed-end aeration branch, so those losses add directly.

When multiple electrical series-count groups coexist in parallel, the current standalone Python heating solver no longer evaluates every group at the same imposed branch flow. Instead it solves a common branch-side pressure requirement together with total-flow continuity. Let

$$\Delta p_{\text{dist,shared}} = \Delta p_{\text{header}} + \Delta p_{\text{header}\to\text{splitter}}$$

denote the flow-path contribution shared by all branches upstream of the splitter outlets. The reported winter total is then

$$\Delta p_{\text{tot,heat}} = \Delta p_{\text{dist,shared}} + \Delta p_{\text{branch,common}}. \tag{86}$$

Here $\Delta p_{\text{branch,common}}$ is the common branch-path drop obtained by enforcing

$$\Delta p_{\text{branch},1}(\dot{m}_1) = \Delta p_{\text{branch},2}(\dot{m}_2) = \cdots = \Delta p_{\text{branch,common}}$$

together with

$$\sum_g N_g \, \dot{m}_g = \dot{m}_{\text{tot}},$$

where $N_g$ is the number of physical branches/tubes that belong to group $g$. The logic behind (86) is a direct node-to-node decomposition of the parallel network. Let $p_0$ denote the common pressure just upstream of the shared distribution hardware, let $p_s$ denote the common pressure at the splitter outlets where the branch families separate, and let $p_{\text{out}}$ denote the downstream outlet-boundary pressure seen by each active branch family. Then

$$\Delta p_{\text{dist,shared}} = p_0 - p_s, \qquad \Delta p_{\text{branch},g}(\dot{m}_g) = p_s - p_{\text{out}}.$$

Equation (86) is therefore just

$$p_0 - p_{\text{out}} = (p_0 - p_s) + (p_s - p_{\text{out}}).$$

The reason the group-specific branch drops are *not* summed across $g$ is that they are alternative parallel routes between the same two nodes, not serial elements traversed one after another by the same fluid parcel. A parcel of air experiences the shared upstream path once, then exactly one branch path. Accordingly, only the shared pre-split loss adds directly to the branch-path loss.

The nontrivial part is that the different branch families need not carry equal diverted flow once their heater-side temperatures, densities, electrical powers, series counts, and helical-obstruction losses differ. In the current implementation the redistributed-flow solve acts on the branch-private splitter-to-outlet quantity stored in code as `privatePathDeltaP_Pa`, not on the final reported total after the shared upstream term is added. Write that group-specific private-path model as

$$\Delta p^{\text{private}}_{\text{branch},g} = F_g(\dot{m}_g),$$

where $F_g$ contains the branch-private splitter-body and connector contractions, heater-tube friction, helical-coil obstruction, heater-to-aeration expansion, and aeration-branch loss for group $g$. Because all active groups connect the same splitter node to the same outlet boundary node, the solved private-path drop is common across the parallel families,

$$F_g(\dot{m}_g) = \Delta p_{\text{branch,common}}.$$

For the operative reduced-order branch models used here, $F_g$ is monotone increasing in $\dot{m}_g$, so the same relation may be written in inverse form as

$$\dot{m}_g = F_g^{-1}(\Delta p_{\text{branch,common}}) \,.$$

The exact outer scalar residual bisected by the Python implementation is therefore

$$R(\Delta p_{\text{branch,common}}) = \sum_g N_g \, F_g^{-1}(\Delta p_{\text{branch,common}}) - \dot{m}_{\text{tot}},$$

and the solve seeks

$$R(\Delta p_{\text{branch,common}}) = 0.$$

Here $N_g$ is the number of physical branches in group $g$. The lower outer bracket is initialized as

$$\Delta p_{\text{lo}}^{(0)} = 0,$$

which corresponds to zero diverted flow through every branch family because the helper returns $\dot{m}_g = 0$ whenever the target branch-private drop is nonpositive. The upper outer bracket is initialized from the largest equal-share branch-private drop,

$$\Delta p_{\text{hi}}^{(0)} = \max_g \left[ \Delta p_{\text{branch},g}^{\text{private}} \left( \frac{\dot{m}_{\text{tot}}}{N_g} \right) \right] .$$

This is only a bracket construction, not the governing equal-flow solution. At iteration $k$, the code forms the midpoint

$$\Delta p_{\text{mid}}^{(k)} = \frac{\Delta p_{\text{lo}}^{(k)} + \Delta p_{\text{hi}}^{(k)}}{2}$$

and the corresponding trial total diverted flow

$$\dot{m}_{\text{trial}}^{(k)} = \sum_g N_g \, F_g^{-1}\left( \Delta p_{\text{mid}}^{(k)} \right) .$$

The bracket update is exactly

$$\begin{cases} \Delta p_{\text{lo}}^{(k+1)} = \Delta p_{\text{mid}}^{(k)}, \quad \Delta p_{\text{hi}}^{(k+1)} = \Delta p_{\text{hi}}^{(k)}, \quad \dot{m}_{\text{trial}}^{(k)} < \dot{m}_{\text{tot}}, \\ \Delta p_{\text{lo}}^{(k+1)} = \Delta p_{\text{lo}}^{(k)}, \quad \Delta p_{\text{hi}}^{(k+1)} = \Delta p_{\text{mid}}^{(k)}, \quad \dot{m}_{\text{trial}}^{(k)} \geq \dot{m}_{\text{tot}}. \end{cases}$$

Thus the lower bound always remains a pressure drop that admits too little total flow, while the upper bound remains a pressure drop that admits at least the required total flow. The outer loop stops when

$$\Delta p_{\text{hi}}^{(k)} - \Delta p_{\text{lo}}^{(k)} \leq \max\left( 10^{-6}, \, 10^{-6} \max\left( \Delta p_{\text{hi}}^{(k)}, 1 \right) \right) ,$$

after which the accepted common private-path drop is

$$\Delta p_{\text{branch,common}} = \Delta p_{\text{hi}}^{(k)}.$$

The inverse map $F_g^{-1}$ is not evaluated analytically. Instead, for each group and each target $\Delta p_{\text{branch,common}}$, the implementation solves the inner scalar equation

$$G_g(\dot{m}) = F_g(\dot{m}) - \Delta p_{\text{branch,common}} = 0$$

by a second bisection. The inner bracket is initialized as

$$\dot{m}_{\mathrm{lo},g}^{(0)} = 0, \qquad \dot{m}_{\mathrm{hi},g}^{(0)} = \frac{\dot{m}_{\mathrm{tot}}}{N_g}.$$

If

$$F_g\left(\dot{m}_{\mathrm{hi},g}^{(0)}\right) \le \Delta p_{\mathrm{branch,common}},$$

the helper returns $\dot{m}_g = \dot{m}_{\mathrm{hi},g}^{(0)}$ immediately. Otherwise it bisects with midpoint

$$\dot{m}_{\mathrm{mid},g}^{(n)} = \frac{\dot{m}_{\mathrm{lo},g}^{(n)} + \dot{m}_{\mathrm{hi},g}^{(n)}}{2}.$$

The code then applies a small-flow guard used only to keep the state evaluation well posed,

$$\dot{m}_{\mathrm{mid},g}^{(n)} \leftarrow \dot{m}_{\mathrm{min,branch}} \qquad \text{if} \qquad 0 < \dot{m}_{\mathrm{mid},g}^{(n)} < \dot{m}_{\mathrm{min,branch}},$$

with $\dot{m}_{\mathrm{min,branch}} =$ `min_branch_mdot_for_state_kg_s`. The inner update is exactly

$$\begin{cases} \dot{m}_{\mathrm{lo},g}^{(n+1)} = \dot{m}_{\mathrm{mid},g}^{(n)}, \quad \dot{m}_{\mathrm{hi},g}^{(n+1)} = \dot{m}_{\mathrm{hi},g}^{(n)}, \quad F_g\left(\dot{m}_{\mathrm{mid},g}^{(n)}\right) \le \Delta p_{\mathrm{branch,common}}, \\ \dot{m}_{\mathrm{lo},g}^{(n+1)} = \dot{m}_{\mathrm{lo},g}^{(n)}, \quad \dot{m}_{\mathrm{hi},g}^{(n+1)} = \dot{m}_{\mathrm{mid},g}^{(n)}, \quad F_g\left(\dot{m}_{\mathrm{mid},g}^{(n)}\right) > \Delta p_{\mathrm{branch,common}}. \end{cases}$$

The inner loop stops when

$$\dot{m}_{\mathrm{hi},g}^{(n)} - \dot{m}_{\mathrm{lo},g}^{(n)} \le \max\left(10^{-9},\, 10^{-6} \max\left(\dot{m}_{\mathrm{hi},g}^{(0)}, 1\right)\right),$$

and the helper returns

$$\dot{m}_g = \dot{m}_{\mathrm{lo},g}^{(n)}.$$

A plain equal-flow evaluation followed only by a post hoc $\max_g$ is therefore not the governing closure when the groups are hydraulically non-identical. Equal-share branch flow appears only in the construction of the outer upper bracket; the final operating point comes from the coupled outer residual $R = 0$ and the inner group-wise inversions above.

If `headerEnabled = false`, then the shared upstream contribution $\Delta p_{\mathrm{dist,shared}}$ vanishes and the modeled distribution loss is entirely branch-private; that is the current active JSON default. In that common case, (86) reduces to $\Delta p_{\mathrm{tot,heat}} = \Delta p_{\mathrm{branch,common}}$, with the redistribution solve still acting on the branch-private splitter, connector, heater, expansion, and aeration terms.

In the current repository this redistributed-flow closure is implemented in the standalone Python heating reference-point solve. For the present default export topology, which uses only one electrical series-count group, the redistributed-flow and equal-flow forms collapse to the same result because every branch family is identical. **Type.** Equations (47)–(86) are standard fluid-mechanics relations plus a repository-configured network assembly, textbook-derived fitting surrogates for unresolved hardware, the segmentwise Ergun porous-bed backpressure reduction, and the closed-end branch shooting closure.

**Repository-native narrative.** `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L862-L961`; `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L1899-L2009`.

**Implementation.** `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L1542-L1668`; `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L1948-L2034`; `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L2203-L2341`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L3128-L3246`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L4205-L4258`;

`heat_transfer_study.py:L4478-L5426`.

**Primary-source citations.** Equations (49)–(50) follow Churchill's explicit all-regime friction relation [R3, pp. 91–92]. Equation (58) uses the standard Ergun packed-bed pressure-drop relation [R15]. The constant default porosity used with that closure is taken from the total-porosity values reported in Fornes et al., Table 2 [R16, p. 299]. Equation (67) uses the Idel'chik Section IV sudden-expansion coefficient on the upstream-velocity basis [R6, p. 112]. Equation (68) uses Idel'chik's Section III contraction relation, equation (3-3), with the Diagram 3-5 bellmouth coefficient [R12, pp. 82–85]; the header-to-splitter and connector-to-branch contraction losses in (76) and (79) are direct uses of that same surrogate. Equation (69) matches Crowl and Louvar's statement of Hooper's 2-$K$ fitting method, equation (4-38) [R14, p. 124]. Equation (70) matches their entrance/exit modification, equation (4-39), with the normal-entrance constants used in (71) taken from the same page [R14, p. 126]. The tee and full-line valve constants used in (72) and (73) come from Table 4-2 [R14, p. 125]. The vented-top outlet-boundary closure (45) uses the same source's simple-hole discussion below equation (4-40), where Crowl and Louvar note $\sum K_f = 1.5$ and $C_d \approx 0.63$ for a hole [R14, p. 126]. Equation (83) is not a direct transcription of a single handbook chart; it is a repository-specific reduced-order projected-area drag surrogate motivated by the Idel'chik wire-ribbing and spiral-ribbed air-heater entries summarized in [R17].

**Deviation note.** The header and splitter-body terms are still surrogates for unresolved hardware, but they are now based on textbook 2-$K$ fitting rows rather than on arbitrary standalone lumped $K$-values. The bed-side backpressure is likewise still reduced-order: the current implementation uses one representative tube-center height, one tributary top area per segment, the nearest-top-opening path length, and a branch-share vent-hole outlet closure when vents exist, but it does not solve a full three-dimensional porous-bed or vent-network flow field. The reported aeration-branch pressure requirement is the inlet gauge pressure needed by the coupled closed-end discharge-plus-friction march, not merely the sum of the explicit tube-friction terms.

## 6 Internal convection correlations

The internal convection coefficient is always formed from

$$h = \frac{Nu\, k}{D}. \tag{87}$$

For laminar developing flow, the implemented Hausen-type relation is

$$Gz = Re\, Pr\, \frac{D}{L}, \tag{88}$$

$$Nu = 3.66 + \frac{0.0668\, Gz}{1 + 0.04\, Gz^{2/3}}, \qquad Re < 2300. \tag{89}$$

For turbulent flow, the implemented Gnielinski relation is

$$Nu = \max\left[3.66,\ \frac{(f/8)(Re - 1000)Pr}{1 + 12.7(f/8)^{1/2}(Pr^{2/3} - 1)}\right], \qquad Re \geq 2300. \tag{90}$$

**Type.** Empirical correlations.

**Repository-native narrative.** `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L80-L103`; `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L862-L961`.

**Implementation.** `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L2382-L2398`; `heat_transfe`

`r_study.py:L3764-L3774`.
**Primary-source citations.** Equation (89) is the Hausen entry-region correlation [R13, pp. 91–98]. Equation (90) follows Gnielinski's turbulent tube-flow relation [R2, pp. 359–368].
**Deviation note.** The same branch logic is used for both heater and aeration tubes. No separate roughness correction or transitional blending beyond the branch cutoff is implemented.

## 7 External convection correlations

For crossflow around the heater wire, the code uses the Churchill–Bernstein correlation

$$Nu = 0.3 + \frac{0.62 Re^{1/2} Pr^{1/3}}{\left[1 + (0.4/Pr)^{2/3}\right]^{1/4}} \left[1 + \left(\frac{Re}{282000}\right)^{5/8}\right]^{4/5}. \tag{91}$$

For external vertical walls, the Rayleigh number is

$$Ra = \frac{g\beta \Delta T L^3}{\nu \alpha}, \tag{92}$$

where $\beta$ is the volumetric thermal-expansion coefficient of the air, $\Delta T$ is the wall-to-ambient temperature difference, and $\alpha$ is the thermal diffusivity. In the implemented vertical-wall model these quantities are evaluated at the film temperature

$$T_f = \frac{T_s + T_\infty}{2}, \qquad T_{f,K} = T_f + 273.15, \tag{93}$$

with

$$\beta = \frac{1}{T_{f,K}}, \qquad \Delta T = |T_s - T_\infty|, \qquad \alpha = \frac{k}{\rho c_p}. \tag{94}$$

Thus, conceptually, $\beta$ measures how strongly the air density changes with temperature, $\Delta T$ is the buoyancy-driving temperature difference, and $\alpha$ measures how quickly heat diffuses through the air relative to the wall length scale. The implementation uses the film-state air properties and enforces only a numerical floor on $\Delta T$ when the wall and ambient temperatures nearly coincide. For insulated side walls, covered tops, and elevated bottoms, $T_s$ denotes the exterior insulation-surface temperature returned by the wall-stack fixed-point solve rather than the interior bed temperature. For an open top or a vent opening, the horizontal free-convection closure still uses the exposed top-surface temperature proxy from the lumped bin model. and the Churchill–Chu plate relation is

$$Nu = \left[0.825 + \frac{0.387 Ra^{1/6}}{\left(1 + (0.492/Pr)^{9/16}\right)^{8/27}}\right]^2, \qquad h = \frac{Nuk}{L}. \tag{95}$$

For horizontal upward-facing top surfaces, or for downward-facing surfaces cooled below ambient, the implemented piecewise free-convection relation is

$$Nu = \begin{cases} 0.54 Ra^{1/4}, & T_s \geq T_\infty,\ Ra \leq 10^7, \\ 0.15 Ra^{1/3}, & T_s \geq T_\infty,\ Ra > 10^7, \\ 0.27 Ra^{1/4}, & T_s < T_\infty. \end{cases} \tag{96}$$

For a downward-facing heated elevated bottom, the code uses the same horizontal-plate family but flips the stable/unstable test relative to the upward-facing top case, so the heated-underside branch

reduces to the stable form $Nu = 0.27Ra^{1/4}$. Here "stable" and "unstable" refer to buoyancy stability of the air layer adjacent to the horizontal surface, not numerical stability. A stable arrangement suppresses overturning of the boundary layer, while an unstable arrangement promotes plume formation and stronger free convection. Thus an upward-facing heated top is unstable because hot, lighter air lies beneath cooler, denser ambient air, whereas a downward-facing heated elevated bottom is stable because the hot, lighter air remains above the cooler ambient air. Conversely, an upward-facing cooled top is stable and a downward-facing cooled bottom is unstable.

**Type.** Empirical correlations.
**Repository-native narrative.** `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L30-L57`; `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L203-L244`; `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L862-L961`.
**Implementation.** `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L1111-L1155`; `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L2372-L2381`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L3710-L3754`.
**Primary-source citations.** Equation (91) is Churchill and Bernstein's overall cylinder-in-crossflow correlation, equation (9) [R1, p. 303]. Equation (95) is the Churchill–Chu isothermal vertical-plate relation, equation (9) [R4, p. 1325].
**Deviation note.** Hole-scale evaporation no longer reuses Churchill–Bernstein. The current moisture model uses a separate Frössling-type Sherwood closure tied to the Idel'chik perforation-discharge velocity in Section 12.

## 8 Conduction and thermal resistance networks

The exterior bin coefficient is treated as a full-geometry effective value, not a side-wall-only value. The model first evaluates orientation-specific wall-stack coefficients, then collapses them into a geometry-inclusive overall exterior coefficient $U_{\text{ext}}$. The side and bottom stacks are

$$U_{\text{side}} = \left(\frac{1}{h_{\text{inside,bin}}} + \frac{t_{\text{sheet}}}{k_{\text{sheet}}} + \frac{t_{\text{ins}}}{k_{\text{ins}}} + \frac{1}{h_{\text{side}}}\right)^{-1},$$

$$U_{\text{bottom}} = \left(\frac{1}{h_{\text{inside,bin}}} + \frac{t_{\text{sheet}}}{k_{\text{sheet}}} + \frac{t_{\text{ins}}}{k_{\text{ins}}} + \frac{1}{h_{\text{bottom}}}\right)^{-1},$$

and for covered-top portions

$$U_{\text{top,cov}} = \left(\frac{1}{h_{\text{inside,bin}}} + \frac{t_{\text{sheet}}}{k_{\text{sheet}}} + \frac{t_{\text{ins}}}{k_{\text{ins}}} + \frac{1}{h_{\text{top,cov}}}\right)^{-1}.$$

The total ambient conductance is then assembled by top mode:

$$UA_{\text{tot,open}} = U_{\text{side}}A_{\text{side}} + U_{\text{bottom}}A_{\text{bottom}} + h_{\text{top}}A_{\text{top}},$$

$$UA_{\text{tot,cov}} = U_{\text{side}}A_{\text{side}} + U_{\text{bottom}}A_{\text{bottom}} + U_{\text{top,cov}}A_{\text{top}},$$

$$UA_{\text{tot,vent}} = U_{\text{side}}A_{\text{side}} + U_{\text{bottom}}A_{\text{bottom}} + U_{\text{top,cov}}A_{\text{top,cov}} + h_{\text{top,vent}}A_{\text{vent}}.$$

Define the total exterior geometric area as

$$A_{\text{ext}} = A_{\text{side}} + A_{\text{bottom}} + A_{\text{top}},$$

and for the active top mode ($* \in \{\text{open}, \text{cov}, \text{vent}\}$):

$$U_{\text{ext}} = \frac{UA_{\text{tot},*}}{A_{\text{ext}}}. \tag{97}$$

Therefore the total bin heat loss is

$$Q_{\text{loss}} = UA_{\text{tot},*}(T_{\text{bin}} - T_\infty) = U_{\text{ext}}A_{\text{ext}}(T_{\text{bin}} - T_\infty).$$

Here

$$h_{\text{bin,in,cfg}} \equiv \texttt{binWall.internalH_W_m2K}, \qquad h_{\text{inside,bin}} = h_{\text{bin,in,cfg}}, \qquad h_{\text{side}} = \frac{Nu_{\text{side}}k_{\text{air}}}{L_{\text{side}}}, \qquad L_{\text{side}} = L_{\text{plate,ref}},$$

with $Nu_{\text{side}}$ from the Churchill–Chu vertical-plate relation (95) evaluated at the exterior insulation-surface temperature. For the horizontal closures used in $U_{\text{bottom}}$, $U_{\text{top,cov}}$, and vent/open-top terms, the heat-transfer coefficients are explicitly

$$h_{\text{top}} = \frac{Nu_{\text{top}}k_{\text{air}}}{L_{c,\text{top}}}, \qquad h_{\text{top,cov}} = \frac{Nu_{\text{top,cov}}k_{\text{air}}}{L_{c,\text{top}}}, \qquad h_{\text{top,vent}} = \frac{Nu_{\text{top,vent}}k_{\text{air}}}{L_{c,\text{vent}}}, \tag{98}$$

$$h_{\text{bottom}} = \frac{Nu_{\text{bottom}}k_{\text{air}}}{L_{c,\text{bottom}}}, \tag{99}$$

with

$$L_{c,\text{top}} = \frac{A_{\text{top}}}{P_{\text{top}}}, \qquad L_{c,\text{bottom}} = \frac{A_{\text{bottom}}}{P_{\text{bottom}}}, \qquad L_{c,\text{vent}} = \frac{A_{\text{vent}}}{P_{\text{vent}}},$$

$$Ra_j = \frac{g\beta_j|T_{s,j} - T_\infty|L_{c,j}^3}{\nu_j\alpha_j}, \qquad j \in \{\text{top}, \text{top}, \text{cov}, \text{top}, \text{vent}, \text{bottom}\},$$

and $k_{\text{air}}, \beta, \nu, \alpha$ evaluated at the corresponding film state. For upward-facing horizontal surfaces $s \in \{\text{top}, \text{top}, \text{cov}, \text{top}, \text{vent}\}$,

$$Nu_s = \begin{cases} 0.54Ra_s^{1/4}, & T_{s,\text{surf}} \geq T_\infty, \quad Ra_s \leq 10^7, \\ 0.15Ra_s^{1/3}, & T_{s,\text{surf}} \geq T_\infty, \quad Ra_s > 10^7, \\ 0.27Ra_s^{1/4}, & T_{s,\text{surf}} < T_\infty, \end{cases} \tag{100}$$

while for the downward-facing bottom surface (stable/unstable branch inverted relative to upward-facing),

$$Nu_{\text{bottom}} = \begin{cases} 0.27Ra_{\text{bottom}}^{1/4}, & T_{s,\text{bottom}} \geq T_\infty, \\ 0.54Ra_{\text{bottom}}^{1/4}, & T_{s,\text{bottom}} < T_\infty, \quad Ra_{\text{bottom}} \leq 10^7, \\ 0.15Ra_{\text{bottom}}^{1/3}, & T_{s,\text{bottom}} < T_\infty, \quad Ra_{\text{bottom}} > 10^7. \end{cases} \tag{101}$$

Thus $h_{\text{bin,in,cfg}}$ is not a free symbolic constant; it is the effective interior wall coefficient taken from the bin-wall input key `internalH_W_m2K`, whose current JSON default is $6.0\,\text{W/m}^2/\text{K}$. The side-wall reference length $L_{\text{plate,ref}}$ defaults to the bin height unless overridden in the environment inputs. In other words, exterior convection is treated orientation-wise ($h_{\text{side}}, h_{\text{bottom}}, h_{\text{top}}, h_{\text{top,cov}}, h_{\text{top,vent}}$), and $U_{\text{ext}}$ is the geometry-inclusive collapse of that full assembly, whereas $h_{\text{inside,bin}}$ is not re-derived from a separate interior air-side convection model. The current implementation prescribes

$$h_{\text{inside,bin}} = h_{\text{bin,in,cfg}},$$

as a constant effective interior bin-side coefficient standing in for the unresolved combined interior free convection and near-wall bed/air exchange at the vessel inner surface. The same planar layered wall stack is also reused later in the habitat post-processing when a radial plume reaches a wall. For that wall-return closure, the inside coefficient is

$$h_{\text{in,wall}} = h_{\text{sens}},$$

and the exterior coefficient is selected by wall orientation:

$$h_{\text{ext,left}} = h_{\text{ext,right}} = h_{\text{side}}, \qquad h_{\text{ext,bottom}} = h_{\text{bottom}},$$

$$h_{\text{ext,top}} = \begin{cases} h_{\text{top}}, & \text{open top,} \\ h_{\text{top,cov}}, & \text{covered top, including covered top with vent holes.} \end{cases}$$

So the wall-return network does not re-solve new local Nusselt correlations at post-processing time; it reuses the orientation-specific coefficients that were already computed in the main bin-loss solve. Specifically, $h_{\text{top}}$ is obtained from the horizontal-plate piecewise closure (96) for the active top mode, and $h_{\text{bottom}}$ is obtained from the same horizontal-plate family with the downward-facing orientation logic (stable/unstable branch inverted relative to the upward-facing top). The wall-return flux and inside-wall temperature for a contacted wall $w \in \{\text{left}, \text{right}, \text{bottom}, \text{top}\}$ are

$$q''_{\text{wall},w} = \frac{T_{\text{plume,wall}} - T_\infty}{\frac{1}{h_{\text{in,wall}}} + \frac{t_{\text{sheet}}}{k_{\text{sheet}}} + \frac{t_{\text{ins}}}{k_{\text{ins}}} + \frac{1}{h_{\text{ext},w}}}, \tag{102}$$

$$T_{\text{wall,in},w} = T_{\text{plume,wall}} - \frac{q''_{\text{wall},w}}{h_{\text{in,wall}}}, \tag{103}$$

with the later post-processing step converting $T_{\text{wall,in},w}$ into a wall-normal unsafe depth by linear interpolation back to the bed temperature.

$$D_{\text{ext}} = D_o + 2t_{\text{ins}}.$$

Then

$$U_{\text{heater}} = \left( \frac{D_{\text{ext}}}{D_i h_{\text{inside,heater}}} + \frac{D_{\text{ext}}}{2k_{\text{wall}}} \ln\left(\frac{D_o}{D_i}\right) + \frac{D_{\text{ext}}}{2k_{\text{ins}}} \ln\left(\frac{D_{\text{ext}}}{D_o}\right) + \frac{1}{h_{\text{outside,heater}}} \right)^{-1}, \tag{104}$$

with

$$h_{\text{inside,heater}} = M_{\text{wall}} \frac{Nu_{\text{heater}} k}{D_i}, \qquad h_{\text{outside,heater}} = h_{\text{heater,ext,cfg}}, \qquad P_{\text{heater,ext}} = \pi D_{\text{ext}},$$

where $Nu_{\text{heater}}$ follows the internal-tube correlation branch in Section 6, $M_{\text{wall}} \equiv$ `model_overrides.calibration.hW` and $h_{\text{heater,ext,cfg}} \equiv$ `heaterTube.externalH_W_m2K`. For the uninsulated aeration tube, Thus $h_{\text{inside,heater}}$ is correlation-derived from the internal-tube Nusselt closure, whereas $h_{\text{outside,heater}}$ is prescribed directly as the constant effective ambient-side heater-shell coefficient already introduced in Section 4.3. The current implementation therefore does not solve a separate exterior natural-convection correlation around the insulated heater tube itself.

$$U_{\text{aer}} = \left( \frac{D_o}{D_i h_{\text{inside,aer}}} + \frac{D_o}{2k_{\text{wall}}} \ln\left(\frac{D_o}{D_i}\right) + \frac{1}{h_{\text{outside,aer}}} \right)^{-1}. \tag{105}$$

with

$$h_{\text{inside,aer}} = M_{\text{wall}} \frac{Nu_{\text{aer}} k}{D_i}, \qquad h_{\text{outside,aer}} = M_{\text{bed}} h_{\text{bed,cfg}}, \qquad P_{\text{aer,out}} = \pi D_o,$$

where $Nu_{\text{aer}}$ follows the internal-tube correlation branch in Section 6, $M_{\text{wall}} \equiv$ `model_overrides.calibration.hWal` $M_{\text{bed}} \equiv$ `model_overrides.calibration.bedHTMultiplier`, and $h_{\text{bed,cfg}} \equiv$ `aeration.bedH_W_m2K`. The current JSON defaults set $M_{\text{wall}} = M_{\text{bed}} = 1.0$ and $h_{\text{bed,cfg}} = 8.0\,\text{W/m}^2/\text{K}$. Thus $h_{\text{inside,aer}}$ is correlation-derived from the internal-tube Nusselt closure, while $h_{\text{outside,aer}}$ remains the prescribed effective bed-side coefficient already introduced in Section 4.4 rather than a separately re-derived external convection coefficient.

**Type.** Thermal resistance networks.
**Repository-native narrative.** `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L103-L200`; `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L203-L244`.
**Implementation.** `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L1102-L1110`; `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L1884-L1894`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L3737-L3778`.
**Deviation note.** The cylindrical heater-tube and aeration-tube wall terms now use exact logarithmic resistances on the exposed outer-area basis. The bin-wall stack remains a planar layered-wall model. The exponential factor $\Theta_i$ is not a fitted correlation; it is the exact segmentwise solution of (32) under the repository's piecewise-constant marching assumptions, consistent with the generic thermal-resistance and differential energy-balance background cited in [R5].

## 9 Heater-side overall heat transfer treatment

The wire-side convective coefficient is

$$h_{\text{wire}} = M_{\text{wire}} \frac{Nu_{\text{wire}} k}{D_{\text{wire}}}, \tag{106}$$

with $Nu_{\text{wire}}$ given by (91) and $M_{\text{wire}} \equiv$ `model_overrides.calibration.hWireMultiplier`. The heater-shell loss per segment is

$$q_{\text{loss},i} = U_{\text{heater}} P_{\text{heater,ext}} \Delta x \left(T_{\text{air},i} - T_\infty\right), \tag{107}$$

where $P_{\text{heater,ext}} = \pi D_{\text{ext}}$ is the exposed outer perimeter of the insulated heater tube, and the local net air heating is

$$q_{\text{to air},i} = q_{\text{gen},i} - q_{\text{loss},i}. \tag{108}$$

**Type.** Derived reduced-order heater balance.
**Repository-native narrative.** `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L38-L121`; `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L1738-L1898`.
**Implementation.** `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L1803-L1894`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L3775-L3895`.
**Deviation note.** The Python physics re-solver mirrors the MATLAB heater equations for annual and diagnostic use, but the winter operating grid itself still originates from MATLAB.

## 10 Aeration-tube heat transfer model

The wall-mediated sensible contribution is evaluated from the exact segment exchange after applying the wall factor (36)–(38),

$$q_{\text{wall},i} = \dot{m}_{\text{mean},i} c_p \left(T_{\text{air},i} - T_{\text{air,after wall},i}\right). \tag{109}$$

Here $T_{\mathrm{air},i}$ denotes the air temperature entering aeration segment $i$, not a constant heater-exit temperature carried unchanged along the tube. In the winter branch, $T_{\mathrm{air},1}$ is the heater-tube outlet temperature (19); in the summer branch, $T_{\mathrm{air},1}$ is reset to the actual spot-cooler supply temperature before the aeration march begins. In the implemented reduced-order closure, the released-air enthalpy term and evaporation term modify the bed-side energy balance and the remaining mass flow, but the retained in-tube air temperature state itself advances through (39) after the wall exchange. The direct released-air enthalpy term is

$$q_{\mathrm{jet},i} = \dot{m}_{\mathrm{rel},i} c_p \left(T_{\mathrm{rel},i} - T_{\mathrm{bed,ref}}\right). \tag{110}$$

Both current rooted branches use the same closed-end discharge law (9) and wall-factor exchange (36)–(40). The winter branch supplies $T_{\mathrm{bed,ref}} = T_{\mathrm{bed}}$, whereas the summer branch supplies the self-consistent branch reference temperature from the two-node cooling solve. In both cases, the net bed contribution still follows (29), so the sign of $q_{\mathrm{jet},i}$ and of the total segment contribution naturally reverses between heating and cooling.

**Type.** Derived reduced-order segment model.
**Repository-native narrative.** `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L151-L205`; `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L2168-L2238`.
**Implementation.** `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L1895-L2076`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L2987-L3277`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L4182-L4323`.
**Deviation note.** The local released-air term remains a lumped enthalpy source or sink; the model still does not resolve the discharged jet field in the surrounding porous bed.

## 11 Warm-air release / jet-heating treatment

The released-air term (110) is the model's surrogate for direct pore-space heating or cooling by discharged air. It should be interpreted as an enthalpy source or sink attached to the released fraction $\dot{m}_{\mathrm{rel},i}$, not as a resolved jet correlation. In the summer branch, the same equation is reused with $T_{\mathrm{air}} < T_{\mathrm{bed,ref}}$, so $q_{\mathrm{jet},i}$ becomes negative and contributes to net cooling. The associated radial plume cooling, worm-safe distance, and habitat-exclusion mathematics are documented in full in the later plume/habitat section beginning at (126).

**Type.** Reduced-order enthalpy model plus repository-specific plume post-processing.
**Repository-native narrative.** `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L1342-L1585`.
**Implementation.** `heat_transfer_study.py:L1062-L1306`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L1686-L1736`.
**Deviation note.** The plume model is not used to modify the main tube-marching solution; it is a separate post-processing estimate.

## 12 Moisture, evaporation, and latent-heat treatment

The current wetted-area basis can be the top plan area, a manual area, or a particle-surface estimate derived from the Table 3 size fractions. For the particle-surface path, the Sauter mean diameter is

$$\frac{1}{d_{32}} = \sum_i \frac{w_i}{d_i}, \tag{111}$$

so the external surface area per occupied bed volume is

$$a_{\text{ext}} = \frac{6}{d_{32}}. \tag{112}$$

If $V_{\text{fill}}$ is the filled bed volume and $f_{\text{access}}$ the accessible wet-surface fraction,

$$A_{\text{wet}} = f_{\text{access}} a_{\text{ext}} V_{\text{fill}}. \tag{113}$$

The Python water-property package imports `IAPWS_95.py` and uses it as the backend for all pure-water saturation properties used by the summer psychrometric and evaporation calculations. In that module, the saturation pressure is evaluated from the IAPWS ancillary relation

$$\ln\left(\frac{p_{\text{sat}}}{p_c}\right) = \frac{T_c}{T}\sum_{i=1}^{6} a_i \tau^{b_i}, \qquad \tau = 1 - \frac{T}{T_c}, \tag{114}$$

and the saturated liquid and vapor densities are taken directly from the Wagner–Pruss auxiliary saturation relations

$$\frac{\rho_{\ell,\text{sat}}}{\rho_c} = 1 + \sum_{i=1}^{6} b_i \tau^{n_i}, \qquad \ln\left(\frac{\rho_{v,\text{sat}}}{\rho_c}\right) = \sum_{i=1}^{6} c_i \tau^{m_i}, \tag{115}$$

with $(n_i) = (1/3,\ 2/3,\ 5/3,\ 16/3,\ 43/3,\ 110/3)$ and $(m_i) = (2/6,\ 4/6,\ 8/6,\ 18/6,\ 37/6,\ 71/6)$. In the current implementation, these auxiliary densities define the saturation states, and the corresponding saturated liquid and vapor enthalpies are then evaluated from the IAPWS-95 Helmholtz enthalpy relation at $(\rho_{\ell,\text{sat}}, T)$ and $(\rho_{v,\text{sat}}, T)$. For humid-air calculations, the vapor-component saturation density still enters on the standard partial-pressure basis $\rho_{v,\text{sat}}^{(\text{air})} = p_{\text{sat}}/(R_v T)$, because the air-side evaporation model tracks water vapor as a constituent of a gas mixture rather than as a pure saturated steam phase. The latent heat is obtained from that Helmholtz-based saturated enthalpy difference,

$$h_{fg}(T) = h_{v,\text{sat}}(T) - h_{\ell,\text{sat}}(T). \tag{116}$$

The model does not resolve the true three-dimensional jet, shear, and interfacial transport field around each perforation and adjacent wetted bed patch. Instead, it combines the Idel'chik orifice-discharge closure from (9)–(11) with a direct Frössling-type mass-transfer surrogate. The tube-side humidity ratio at release is held equal to the upstream tube value $w_{\text{tube}}$, and the corresponding local vapor density in the released air is

$$\rho_{v,\infty} = \min\left[\frac{p\, w_{\text{tube}}}{(0.62198 + w_{\text{tube}}) R_v T_{\text{air}}}, \rho_{v,\text{sat}}(T_{\text{air}})\right]. \tag{117}$$

The hole Reynolds number is then

$$Re_{\text{hole}} = \frac{\rho u_{\text{hole}} D_{\text{hole}}}{\mu}, \tag{118}$$

and the current code fixes the air/water-vapor Schmidt number at $Sc_{\text{wv,a}} = 0.60$. The Frössling Sherwood closure is written

$$Sh_{\text{hole}} = M_{Sh}\left[2 + 0.552\, Re_{\text{hole}}^{1/2} Sc_{\text{wv,a}}^{1/3}\right], \tag{119}$$

where $M_{Sh} \equiv$ `model_overrides.calibration.evaporationSherwoodMultiplier` in the current JSON defaults, with backward-compatible fallback to the legacy key `model_overrides.calibration.evaporationH`

The current JSON default sets $M_{Sh} = 1.0$. Using $Sc_{\mathrm{wv,a}}$ as a constant, the code forms an effective vapor diffusivity and mass-transfer coefficient as

$$D_{va} = \frac{\mu}{\rho Sc_{\mathrm{wv,a}}}, \qquad h_m = \frac{Sh_{\mathrm{hole}} D_{va}}{D_{\mathrm{hole}}}. \tag{120}$$

The vapor-density driving force is

$$\Delta\rho_v = \max[\rho_{v,\mathrm{sat}}(T_s) - \rho_{v,\infty},\, 0]\,. \tag{121}$$

The diffusion-limited, carrying-capacity-limited, and heat-limited evaporation rates are

$$\dot{m}_{\mathrm{diff}} = h_m A_{\mathrm{seg}} \Delta\rho_v, \tag{122}$$

$$\dot{m}_{\mathrm{cap}} = \dot{V}_{\mathrm{rel,seg}} \Delta\rho_v, \tag{123}$$

$$\dot{m}_{\mathrm{heat}} = \frac{q_{\mathrm{avail}}}{h_{fg}}, \qquad q_{\mathrm{avail}} = \max[\dot{m}_{\mathrm{rel,seg}} c_p (T_{\mathrm{air}} - T_{\mathrm{bed}}),\, 0]\,. \tag{124}$$

The implemented segment evaporation rate and latent sink are

$$\dot{m}_{\mathrm{evap,seg}} = \max[0,\, \min(\dot{m}_{\mathrm{diff}}, \dot{m}_{\mathrm{cap}}, \dot{m}_{\mathrm{heat}})]\,, \qquad q_{\mathrm{evap,seg}} = \dot{m}_{\mathrm{evap,seg}} h_{fg}. \tag{125}$$

**Type.** Combination of IAPWS-based pure-water property evaluation, empirical transport relations, and repository-specific area bookkeeping.
**Repository-native narrative.** `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L1015-L1369`; `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L1586-L1609`; `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L2238-L2245`.
**Implementation.** `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L891-L937`; `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L2000-L2122`; `IAPWS_95.py:L614-L691`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L1379-L1459`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L2794-L2823`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L3946-L4003`.
**Primary-source citations.** The particle-size fractions entering (111) come from Frederickson et al., Table 3 [R11, pp. S320–S326]. Equation (114) matches the Wagner–Pruss vapor-pressure auxiliary equation, equation (2.5) [R9, p. 399]. The saturated-liquid and saturated-vapor density closures in (115) are Wagner–Pruss equations (2.6)–(2.7) [R9, p. 399] and are now used directly in the Python implementation through `IAPWS_95.py`. Equation (119) follows the Frössling relation as restated by Towler and Sinnott [R8, Eq. 15.11]. Equation (116) is implemented from the IAPWS-95 Helmholtz enthalpy relation evaluated at those auxiliary saturation densities; Wagner and Pruss equations (2.10)–(2.11) [R9, p. 400] are the corresponding literature-side saturation-boundary enthalpy relations, but they are not the direct computational path used in the current Python backend.
**Deviation note.** The summer branch computes the inlet tube humidity after spot-cooler condensate removal, so the effective release humidity ratio and $\rho_{v,\infty}$ are not always the raw ambient-RH state. The external wet-patch humidity rise caused by prior local evaporation is still unresolved; only the released-air tube-side vapor state is represented explicitly.

## 13 Radial plume, worm-safe stand-off, and habitat-exclusion post-processing

The released-air post-processing model starts from the released mass flow rate per unit aeration-tube length,

$$\dot{m}'_{\mathrm{rel}} = \frac{\dot{m}_{\mathrm{tube,in}}}{L_{\mathrm{aer}}}, \tag{126}$$

and the wetted-area density

$$a_{\text{wet}} = \frac{A_{\text{wet}}}{V_{\text{fill}}}. \tag{127}$$

The local wet-surface sink temperature is clamped between the configured surface temperature, the bed-reference temperature, and the released-air temperature:

$$T_{\text{sink}} = \min(\max(T_{s,\text{set}}, T_{\text{bed,ref}}), T_{\text{air,out}}) \,. \tag{128}$$

The plume radius is grown as

$$b(x) = \min(b_{\max},\, b_0 + \alpha x) \,, \tag{129}$$

so the contacted wetted area per radial length is

$$A'_{\text{wet}}(x) = \pi a_{\text{wet}} b(x)^2. \tag{130}$$

In this post-processing model the local coefficients are written directly as

$$h_{\text{sens}} = M_{\text{bed}} h_{\text{bed,cfg}}, \qquad h_{\text{evap}} = M_{Sh} h_{\text{sens}},$$

where $M_{\text{bed}} \equiv$ `model_overrides.calibration.bedHTMultiplier`, $h_{\text{bed,cfg}} \equiv$ `aeration.bedH_W_m2K`, and $M_{Sh} \equiv$ `model_overrides.calibration.evaporationSherwoodMultiplier` with backward-compatible fallback to `model_overrides.calibration.evaporationHMultiplier`. The sensible and latent radial sink terms are In this post-processing plume model, $h_{\text{sens}}$ is therefore not a newly re-derived local convection coefficient; it reuses the same prescribed effective bed-side sensible coefficient basis as the aeration wall model, scaled by $M_{\text{bed}}$. Likewise, $h_{\text{evap}}$ is not an independent Nusselt-based heat-transfer coefficient; it is a Sherwood-side multiplier applied to that same sensible baseline for the Lewis-relation mass-transfer surrogate.

$$q'_{\text{sens}}(x) = h_{\text{sens}} A'_{\text{wet}}(x) \left(T - T_{\text{sink}}\right) , \tag{131}$$

$$q'_{\text{lat}}(x) = \dot{m}'_{\text{evap}}(x) h_{fg}(T_s), \tag{132}$$

and the plume temperature satisfies

$$\dot{m}'_{\text{rel}} c_p \frac{dT}{dx} = -\left[q'_{\text{sens}}(x) + q'_{\text{lat}}(x)\right] . \tag{133}$$

The local mass-transfer coefficient is formed by the Lewis relation using local air properties,

$$h_m(x) = \frac{h_{\text{evap}}}{\rho_{\text{air}}(T) c_{p,\text{air}} \text{Le}^{2/3}}, \tag{134}$$

which gives the potential diffusion-driven evaporation rate per radial length,

$$\dot{m}'_{\text{evap,pot}} = h_m(x) A'_{\text{wet}}(x) \left[\rho_{v,\text{sat}}(T_s) - \rho_{v,\text{bulk}}(x)\right] . \tag{135}$$

The code advances the plume humidity explicitly and caps the bulk vapor density at saturation at the updated plume temperature `heat_transfer_study.py:L1241-L1292`. If the worm-safety threshold is $T_{\text{safe}}$, the safe radial offset is the first $x$ such that

$$T(x) = T_{\text{safe}}, \tag{136}$$

located in the code by interpolation on the numerically marched profile `heat_transfer_study.py:L1307-L1332`.

For habitat accounting, the filled-bed height and volume are

$$H_{\text{fill}} = f_{\text{fill}} H, \qquad V_{\text{fill}} = LWH_{\text{fill}}, \tag{137}$$

with filled-bed cross section

$$\Omega_{\text{fill}} = \{(x, y) : 0 \le x \le W,\ 0 \le y \le H_{\text{fill}}\}. \tag{138}$$

If the safe offset is $x_{\text{safe}}$, the exclusion radius around each tube is

$$R_{\text{exc}} = r_0 + x_{\text{safe}}. \tag{139}$$

The pipe and exclusion indicator functions are

$$I_{\text{pipe}}(x, y) = \begin{cases} 1, & \exists i:\ (x - x_i)^2 + (y - y_i)^2 \le r_0^2, \\ 0, & \text{otherwise}, \end{cases} \tag{140}$$

$$I_{\text{exc}}(x, y) = \begin{cases} 1, & \exists i:\ (x - x_i)^2 + (y - y_i)^2 \le R_{\text{exc}}^2, \\ 0, & \text{otherwise}. \end{cases} \tag{141}$$

The overlap-aware union areas are

$$A_{\text{pipe,union}} = \iint_{\Omega_{\text{fill}}} I_{\text{pipe}}(x, y)\, dA, \tag{142}$$

$$A_{\text{exc,union}} = \iint_{\Omega_{\text{fill}}} I_{\text{exc}}(x, y)\, dA, \tag{143}$$

with volumes obtained by extrusion over aeration-tube length,

$$V_{\text{pipe}} = A_{\text{pipe,union}} L_{\text{aer}}, \qquad V_{\text{exc}} = A_{\text{exc,union}} L_{\text{aer}}. \tag{144}$$

The shell-only unsafe volume and remaining habitable volume are then

$$V_{\text{unsafe,shell}} = V_{\text{exc}} - V_{\text{pipe}}, \tag{145}$$

$$V_{\text{hab}} = V_{\text{fill}} - V_{\text{unsafe,total}}. \tag{146}$$

When the radial plume reaches the left, right, bottom, or top boundary of the filled-bed cross section, the code computes an inside-wall temperature using the same orientation-specific wall-return resistance network defined in Section 8. That network reuses $h_{\text{side}}$, $h_{\text{bottom}}$, $h_{\text{top}}$, and $h_{\text{top,cov}}$ from the main bin-loss model rather than re-solving new local exterior Nusselt relations here. Those reused coefficients were already obtained from the vertical/horizontal free-convection closures in Section 7, with $h_{\text{bottom}}$ from the downward-facing horizontal logic and $h_{\text{top}}/h_{\text{top,cov}}$ from the upward-facing horizontal logic. Top wall-return uses $h_{\text{top,cov}}$ whenever the top is physically covered, including covered tops with vent holes. The resulting $T_{\text{wall,in},w}$ is then converted to an added unsafe band depth by linear wall-normal interpolation between the bed temperature and the wall-contact temperature `heat_transfer_study.py:L1531-L1555`. The final reported unsafe volume is the union of plume exclusion cylinders and wall-return bands:

$$V_{\text{unsafe,total}} = V_{\text{union}}. \tag{147}$$

For overlap reporting, the naive no-overlap sums are

$$A_{\text{pipe,sum}} = N_{\text{tubes}}\pi r_0^2, \qquad A_{\text{exc,sum}} = N_{\text{tubes}}\pi R_{\text{exc}}^2, \tag{148}$$

with overlap corrections

$$A_{\text{pipe,ov}} = A_{\text{pipe,sum}} - A_{\text{pipe,union}}, \qquad A_{\text{exc,ov}} = A_{\text{exc,sum}} - A_{\text{exc,union}}. \tag{149}$$

Numerically, the union areas are evaluated on a midpoint grid:

$$A \approx \left(\frac{WH_{\text{fill}}}{N_g^2}\right)\sum_{j=1}^{N_g}\sum_{k=1}^{N_g} I(x_j^*, y_k^*). \tag{150}$$

**Type.** Repository-specific radial thermal/moisture post-processing and overlap-aware geometry bookkeeping.
**Repository-native narrative.** `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L1277-L1571`.
**Implementation.** `heat_transfer_study.py:L1119-L1367`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L1440-L1664`.
**Deviation note.** The plume model is not part of the core heater or cooling-march solve. It is a post-processing estimator used for the radial cooling plot and the habitat-exclusion metrics.

## 14 Bin-wall and ambient heat-loss model

The vessel geometry is

$$A_{\text{side}} = 2HL + 2HW, \qquad A_{\text{bottom}} = LW, \qquad A_{\text{top}} = LW. \tag{151}$$

With $N_{\text{vent}}$ top vent holes of diameter $d_{\text{vent}}$,

$$A_{\text{vent}} = N_{\text{vent}}\frac{\pi d_{\text{vent}}^2}{4}, \qquad A_{\text{top,cov}} = A_{\text{top}} - A_{\text{vent}}. \tag{152}$$

For horizontal top and bottom surfaces, the characteristic lengths are taken as

$$L_{c,\text{top}} = \frac{A_{\text{top}}}{P_{\text{top}}}, \qquad L_{c,\text{bottom}} = \frac{A_{\text{bottom}}}{P_{\text{bottom}}}, \qquad P_{\text{top}} = P_{\text{bottom}} = 2(L+W), \tag{153}$$

so the exposed-top and elevated-bottom natural-convection coefficients are

$$h_{\text{top}} = \frac{Nu_{\text{top}}k}{L_{c,\text{top}}}, \qquad h_{\text{bottom}} = \frac{Nu_{\text{bottom}}k}{L_{c,\text{bottom}}}. \tag{154}$$

The side-wall, vent, and covered-top coefficients used below are

$$h_{\text{side}} = \frac{Nu_{\text{side}}k_{\text{air}}}{L_{\text{side}}}, \qquad L_{\text{side}} = L_{\text{plate,ref}}, \qquad h_{\text{top,vent}} = \frac{Nu_{\text{top,vent}}k}{L_{c,\text{vent}}},$$

$$L_{c,\text{vent}} = \frac{A_{\text{vent}}}{P_{\text{vent}}}, \qquad P_{\text{vent}} = N_{\text{vent}}\pi d_{\text{vent}}, \qquad h_{\text{top,cov}} = \frac{Nu_{\text{top,cov}}k}{L_{c,\text{top}}}.$$

Here $Nu_{\text{side}}$ follows the Churchill–Chu vertical-plate relation (95); $Nu_{\text{top}}$, $Nu_{\text{top,vent}}$, and $Nu_{\text{top,cov}}$ follow (96); and $Nu_{\text{bottom}}$ uses the same horizontal-plate family with the stable branch selected for

a heated downward-facing elevated underside. The overall insulated-surface coefficients used below are therefore

$$U_{\text{side}} = \left(\frac{1}{h_{\text{inside,bin}}} + \frac{t_{\text{sheet}}}{k_{\text{sheet}}} + \frac{t_{\text{ins}}}{k_{\text{ins}}} + \frac{1}{h_{\text{side}}}\right)^{-1}, \qquad U_{\text{bottom}} = \left(\frac{1}{h_{\text{inside,bin}}} + \frac{t_{\text{sheet}}}{k_{\text{sheet}}} + \frac{t_{\text{ins}}}{k_{\text{ins}}} + \frac{1}{h_{\text{bottom}}}\right)^{-1},$$

$$U_{\text{top,cov}} = \left(\frac{1}{h_{\text{inside,bin}}} + \frac{t_{\text{sheet}}}{k_{\text{sheet}}} + \frac{t_{\text{ins}}}{k_{\text{ins}}} + \frac{1}{h_{\text{top,cov}}}\right)^{-1}, \qquad h_{\text{inside,bin}} = h_{\text{bin,in,cfg}}.$$

Each Rayleigh evaluation is carried out at the corresponding exterior insulation-surface temperature, and the side-wall reference length $L_{\text{plate,ref}}$ defaults to the bin height unless overridden. The total vessel heat-loss forms can then be written explicitly as

$$Q_{\text{loss,closed}} = (U_{\text{side}}A_{\text{side}} + U_{\text{bottom}}A_{\text{bottom}} + U_{\text{top,cov}}A_{\text{top}})\,(T_{\text{bin}} - T_\infty), \tag{155}$$

$$Q_{\text{loss,open}} = (U_{\text{side}}A_{\text{side}} + U_{\text{bottom}}A_{\text{bottom}})\,(T_{\text{bin}} - T_\infty) + h_{\text{top}}A_{\text{top}}(T_{\text{bin}} - T_\infty). \tag{156}$$

For an open top, the top-node and total ambient conductances are

$$UA_{\text{top,open}} = U_{\text{side}}A_{\text{top,wallshare}} + h_{\text{top}}A_{\text{top}}, \tag{157}$$

$$UA_{\text{tot,open}} = U_{\text{side}}A_{\text{side}} + U_{\text{bottom}}A_{\text{bottom}} + h_{\text{top}}A_{\text{top}}. \tag{158}$$

For a covered top with a small vent,

$$UA_{\text{top,vented}} = U_{\text{side}}A_{\text{top,wallshare}} + U_{\text{top,cov}}A_{\text{top,cov}} + h_{\text{top,vent}}A_{\text{vent}}, \tag{159}$$

$$UA_{\text{tot,vented}} = U_{\text{side}}A_{\text{side}} + U_{\text{bottom}}A_{\text{bottom}} + U_{\text{top,cov}}A_{\text{top,cov}} + h_{\text{top,vent}}A_{\text{vent}}. \tag{160}$$

For a fully covered top,

$$UA_{\text{tot,closed}} = U_{\text{side}}A_{\text{side}} + U_{\text{bottom}}A_{\text{bottom}} + U_{\text{top,cov}}A_{\text{top}}. \tag{161}$$

For any active top mode, define

$$A_{\text{ext}} = A_{\text{side}} + A_{\text{bottom}} + A_{\text{top}}, \qquad U_{\text{ext}} = \frac{UA_{\text{tot,mode}}}{A_{\text{ext}}},$$

with $UA_{\text{tot,mode}} \in \{UA_{\text{tot,open}}, UA_{\text{tot,vented}}, UA_{\text{tot,closed}}\}$. Then

$$Q_{\text{loss}} = UA_{\text{tot,mode}}(T_{\text{bin}} - T_\infty) = U_{\text{ext}}A_{\text{ext}}(T_{\text{bin}} - T_\infty).$$

In the executable model outputs, this geometry-inclusive effective value is reported as `externalU_W_m2K`, while `externalH_W_m2K` remains the side-wall natural-convection coefficient $h_{\text{side}}$. The lumped required heating or cooling load is

$$Q_{\text{req}} = UA_{\text{tot}}\,(T_{\text{set}} - T_\infty)\,. \tag{162}$$

The reference ambient coefficient entering the Biot estimate is taken as the largest active exterior coefficient in the current top-mode closure,

$$h_{\text{ext,ref}} = \max(h_{\text{side}},\, h_{\text{bottom}},\, h_{\text{top,mode}})\,,$$

where $h_{\text{top,mode}} = h_{\text{top}}$ for an open top, $h_{\text{top,mode}} = h_{\text{top,vent}}$ for a vented top, and $h_{\text{top,mode}} = h_{\text{top,cov}}$ for a fully covered top. The characteristic length and Biot estimate are

$$L_c = \frac{V_{\text{fill}}}{A_{\text{side}} + A_{\text{bottom}} + A_{\text{top}}}, \qquad Bi = \frac{h_{\text{ext,ref}} L_c}{k_{\text{bed}}}. \tag{163}$$

The lumped time constant is

$$\tau = \frac{C}{U A_{\text{tot}}}, \tag{164}$$

and the associated cooldown curve is

$$T(t) = T_\infty + (T_0 - T_\infty)\, e^{-t/\tau}. \tag{165}$$

**Type.** Derived thermal-network relations plus a repository-specific vented-cover extension.
**Repository-native narrative.** `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L603-L847`.
**Implementation.** `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L971-L1171`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L4326-L4431`.
**Deviation note.** The rooted execution path only plots the lumped cooldown curve when $Bi < 0.1$; the equation exists regardless, but the code treats the plot as conditionally valid rather than unconditional. The current JSON default takes `bottomBoundaryMode="elevated_air_gap"`, so the insulated bottom is treated as an elevated underside exchanging by horizontal free convection to ambient air; any other string falls back to the legacy side-wall surrogate for the bottom boundary.

## 14.1 Summer spot-cooler and assist-blower surrogate

In the summer branch, the requested sensible cooling duty for target supply temperature $T_{\text{supply,target}}$ is

$$\dot{Q}_{\text{req,cool}} = \max[\dot{m} c_p \left(T_{\text{amb}} - T_{\text{supply,target}}\right), 0]. \tag{166}$$

The actual sensible cooling applied by the spot cooler is capped at the configured or derived sensible capacity:

$$\dot{Q}_{\text{actual,cool}} = \min\Big(\dot{Q}_{\text{req,cool}}, \dot{Q}_{\text{max,cool}}\Big), \qquad T_{\text{supply}} = T_{\text{amb}} - \frac{\dot{Q}_{\text{actual,cool}}}{\dot{m} c_p}. \tag{167}$$

If a coefficient of performance is supplied,

$$P_{\text{spot}} = \frac{\dot{Q}_{\text{actual,cool}}}{\text{COP}}. \tag{168}$$

The aeration-network inlet is then reset to the actual spot-cooler supply state,

$$T_{\text{air,in}} = T_{\text{supply,actual}}, \tag{169}$$

while the electrical heater is disabled:

$$P_{\text{tot}} = 0, \qquad I_{\text{tot}} = 0. \tag{170}$$

The post-cooler condensate calculation uses the dry-air flow rate $\dot{m}_{\text{dry}}$ and the saturated outlet humidity ratio $w_{\text{sat,out}}$:

$$\dot{m}_{\text{cond,psych}} = \max[\dot{m}_{\text{dry}} \left(w_{\text{in}} - w_{\text{sat,out}}\right), 0]. \tag{171}$$

If a rated condensate capacity $\dot{m}_{\text{cond,rated}}$ is provided, the applied condensate rate is

$$\dot{m}_{\text{cond}} = \min(\dot{m}_{\text{cond,psych}}, \dot{m}_{\text{cond,rated}}), \tag{172}$$

otherwise $\dot{m}_{\text{cond}} = \dot{m}_{\text{cond,psych}}$. The supply humidity ratio is then

$$w_{\text{out}} = \max\left(w_{\text{in}} - \frac{\dot{m}_{\text{cond}}}{\dot{m}_{\text{dry}}}, 0\right). \tag{173}$$

The assist blower is represented by a linear static curve. With shutoff pressure $\Delta p_{\text{shutoff}}$, rated-duty point $(\dot{V}_{\text{rated}}, \Delta p_{\text{rated}})$, and implied free-air flow $\dot{V}_{\text{free}}$,

$$\dot{V}_{\text{free}} = \dot{V}_{\text{rated}} \frac{\Delta p_{\text{shutoff}}}{\Delta p_{\text{shutoff}} - \Delta p_{\text{rated}}}, \tag{174}$$

$$\Delta p_{\text{avail}}(\dot{V}) = \max\left[\Delta p_{\text{shutoff}}\left(1 - \frac{\dot{V}}{\dot{V}_{\text{free}}}\right), 0\right]. \tag{175}$$

The sampled summer flow is now treated as a requested target $\dot{V}_{\text{req}}$, not as an automatically achieved operating point. The code first evaluates the full reduced-order system pressure requirement $\Delta p_{\text{tot}}(\dot{V})$ from the spot-cooler state, distribution losses, closed-end aeration-tube march, evaporation model, and two-node bed closure. It then forms the scalar blower/system residual

$$R_{\dot{V}}(\dot{V}) = \Delta p_{\text{tot}}(\dot{V}) - \Delta p_{\text{avail}}(\dot{V}). \tag{176}$$

The achieved cooling flow is

$$\dot{V}_{\text{ach}} = \begin{cases} \dot{V}_{\text{req}}, & R_{\dot{V}}(\dot{V}_{\text{req}}) \le 0, \\ \dot{V} \in [0, \dot{V}_{\text{req}}] \text{ such that } R_{\dot{V}}(\dot{V}) = 0, & R_{\dot{V}}(\dot{V}_{\text{req}}) > 0. \end{cases} \tag{177}$$

All reported summer quantities are then recomputed at $\dot{V}_{\text{ach}}$, so the returned aeration inlet gauge pressure, branch pressure profile, segment releases, and cooling duty are mechanically consistent with the assist-blower curve rather than merely post-checked against it. The total summer water-loss rate is

$$\dot{m}_{\text{water,day}} = 86400\, N_{\text{tubes}} \sum_i \dot{m}_{\text{evap},i}, \tag{178}$$

the reported net cooling is

$$Q_{\text{cool}} = \max(-Q_{\text{bed,total}}, 0), \tag{179}$$

and the corresponding lumped cooling requirement at the cooling setpoint is

$$Q_{\text{req,cool}} = U A_{\text{tot}} \left(T_{\infty,\text{summer}} - T_{\text{set,cool}}\right). \tag{180}$$

**Type.** Repository-specific surrogate model. Equations (166)–(168) are simplified sensible-capacity relations; (171)–(173) are psychrometric mass-balance relations; (174)–(177) are a linearized blower curve plus repository operating-point closure.
**Repository-native narrative.** `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L2084-L2284`.
**Implementation.** `heat_transfer_study.py:L2760-L3378`.
**Deviation note.** The blower curve is still a two-point linear approximation rather than a full manufacturer fan map, and the spot-cooler model does not include a detailed refrigeration-cycle calculation. The new operating-point solve corrects the previous inconsistency where an infeasible requested flow could be marched thermally and only later flagged by a static-pressure residual.

## 15 Constraints and feasibility conditions

The current heating hard-constraint residual vector is

$$\mathbf{g}_{\text{heat}} = \begin{bmatrix} \max(0, I - I_{\max}) \\ \max(0, T_{\text{wire}} - T_{\text{wire,max}}) \\ \max(0, T_{\text{air,out}} - T_{\text{air,out,max}}) \\ \max(0, \Delta p - \Delta p_{\max}) \\ \max(0, \dot{m}_{\text{water}} - \dot{m}_{\text{water,max}}) \\ \max(0, u_h - u_{h,\max}) \\ \max(0, T_{b,\min} - T_b) \\ \max(0, T_{t,\min} - T_t) \\ \max(0, T_b - T_{b,\max}) \\ \max(0, T_t - T_{t,\max}) \\ \max(0, |T_b - T_t| - \Delta T_{\max}) \\ \max(0, \text{dutyNeeded} - 1) \\ \max(0, -Q_{\text{bed,total}}) \end{bmatrix}. \tag{181}$$

The current cooling hard-constraint residual vector is

$$\mathbf{g}_{\text{cool}} = \begin{bmatrix} \max(0, \Delta p - \Delta p_{\text{avail}}) \\ \max(0, \Delta p - \Delta p_{\max}) \\ \max(0, \dot{m}_{\text{water}} - \dot{m}_{\text{water,max}}) \\ \max(0, u_h - u_{h,\max}) \\ \max(0, T_{b,\min} - T_b) \\ \max(0, T_{t,\min} - T_t) \\ \max(0, T_b - T_{b,\max}) \\ \max(0, T_t - T_{t,\max}) \\ \max(0, |T_b - T_t| - \Delta T_{\max}) \\ \max(0, -Q_{\text{cool}}) \end{bmatrix}, \tag{182}$$

where $Q_{\text{cool}} = \max(-Q_{\text{bed,total}}, 0)$.

**Type.** Repository-defined feasibility residuals.
**Repository-native narrative.** Heating constraints appear in `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L1614-L1738`. The historical summer lexicographic block at `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L2251-L2279` is intentionally *not* treated as governing because the live Python code now uses constrained NSGA-II for cooling.
**Implementation.** `heat_transfer_study.py:L2220-L2451`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L2963-L3147`.
**Deviation note.** The cooling NSGA-II constraints require positive cooling capacity, but they do *not* currently enforce $Q_{\text{cool}} \geq Q_{\text{req,cool}}$. Cooling shortfall is computed for diagnostics, not as a hard feasibility constraint.

## 16 Objective functions and optimization quantities

Heating now uses constrained NSGA-II on the discrete candidate grid with objective vector

$$\mathbf{f}_{\text{heat}} = \begin{bmatrix} P_{\text{tot}} \\ -\min(T_b, T_t) \\ |T_b - T_t| \end{bmatrix}. \tag{183}$$

The reported heating design is then selected from the feasible Pareto set by the report-priority tuple

$$\pi_{\text{heat,report}} = \begin{bmatrix} -\min(T_b, T_t) \\ P_{\text{tot}} \\ |T_b - T_t| \\ -\frac{1}{2}(T_b + T_t) \\ \max(0, \text{dutyNeeded} - 1) \end{bmatrix}. \tag{184}$$

Cooling now uses constrained NSGA-II as well. The default cooling objective vector is

$$\mathbf{f}_{\text{cool}} = \begin{bmatrix} \max(T_b, T_t) \\ \frac{1}{2}(T_b + T_t) \\ P_{\text{spot}} + P_{\text{blower}} \end{bmatrix}, \tag{185}$$

and the reported cooling design is selected from the feasible cooling Pareto set by

$$\pi_{\text{cool,report}} = \begin{bmatrix} \max(T_b, T_t) \\ \frac{1}{2}(T_b + T_t) \\ P_{\text{spot}} + P_{\text{blower}} \\ \dot{V}_{\text{tot}} \\ |T_b - T_t| \\ -Q_{\text{cool}} \end{bmatrix}. \tag{186}$$

If no feasible cooling Pareto point exists, the code falls back to a best-available diagnostic ranking using the configured ordered tuple

$$\pi_{\text{cool,fallback}} = \left[g_{\sigma(1)}, g_{\sigma(2)}, \ldots, g_{\sigma(m)}\right], \tag{187}$$

where $\sigma$ is the configured `priority_order` permutation over the implemented cooling metrics and residuals `heat_transfer_study.py:L3133-L3149`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L3173-L3177`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L3244-L3246`. This is a live fallback/reporting rule, not the stale historical summer primary-selection rule described in `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L2251-L2279`.

**Type.** Repository-defined optimization quantities.
**Repository-native narrative.** Heating NSGA-II is described in `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L1614-L1738`. The stale summer lexicographic primary-selection narrative in `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L2251-L2279` is intentionally excluded from the governing-equation set here because it is not implemented.
**Implementation.** `heat_transfer_study.py:L51-L121`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L2181-L2499`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L3148-L3208`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L6220-L6490`.
**Deviation note.** NSGA-II is used on an already evaluated discrete set. It is not replacing the physics solve with a continuous surrogate optimizer.

## 17 Numerical approximations, interpolation, and discretization

- The heating design space is generated by exhaustive discrete sweep in MATLAB, not by direct continuous optimization `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L1172-L1476`.
- Electrical resistance depends on average wire temperature, so each operating point uses a short fixed-point iteration on $T_{\text{wire,avg}}$ `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L1497-L1536`.

- Heater and aeration transport are solved by explicit axial marching over configured segment counts `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L1803-L1999`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L2707-L2959`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L3775-L3959`.
- When the assist blower is enabled, the summer branch treats the sampled flow as a request and applies an outer scalar bisection on $\dot{V}$ so that $\Delta p_{\mathrm{tot}}(\dot{V})$ matches the available blower static if the requested flow is not directly achievable `heat_transfer_study.py:L2793-L2858`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L3061-L3378`.
- The summer branch solves for a bed-reference temperature by bracketing and bisection over the scalar residual relating branch cooling to the lumped required cooling target `heat_transfer_study.py:L2774-L2899`.
- Display interpolation in the plotting layer is presentation-only and does not alter the underlying evaluated candidate set `heat_transfer_study.py:L555-L562`.
- The annual climate layer uses periodic Gaussian-kernel regression over day-of-year and then overlays freeze-day and heat-wave events `heat_transfer_study.py:L4633-L4858`.
- Radial plume and habitat calculations use midpoint-grid union-area estimates rather than closed-form geometric intersection formulas `heat_transfer_study.py:L1383-L1595`.
- NSGA-II is applied to integer-valued indices or discrete point indices through `pymoo`; the optimizer explores the discrete repository candidate set rather than an interpolated continuous space `heat_transfer_study.py:L2410-L2499`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L3123-L3208`.

### Detailed marching and fixed-point closures

The current heating solver uses the temperature-dependent wire resistivity

$$\rho_{\mathrm{wire}}(T) = \rho_{\mathrm{wire},20}\left[1 + \alpha_{\mathrm{wire}}(T - 20^{\circ}\mathrm{C})\right], \tag{188}$$

which yields a tube or branch resistance of the form already introduced in (14). The fixed-point iteration updates the average wire temperature by under-relaxation:

$$\overline{T}_{\mathrm{wire}}^{(k+1)} = 0.65\,\overline{T}_{\mathrm{wire}}^{(k)} + 0.35\,\overline{T}_{\mathrm{wire,new}}^{(k)}, \tag{189}$$

and stops when

$$\left|\overline{T}_{\mathrm{wire,new}}^{(k)} - \overline{T}_{\mathrm{wire}}^{(k)}\right| < 0.05^{\circ}\mathrm{C}, \tag{190}$$

or when the configured iteration cap is reached `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L1497-L1536`. The winter aeration pressure-drop march uses the segment contribution

$$\Delta p_{\mathrm{seg}} = f\frac{\Delta x}{D}\frac{\rho u^2}{2}, \tag{191}$$

with the area-change and distribution-network losses added separately through the full Section 5 assembly `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L1953-L1956`; `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L2123-L2232`.

For the closed-end aeration inlet-pressure shooting solve, the scalar residual is the terminal remaining flow above the mass-balance tolerance,

$$F(p_{\mathrm{in}}) = \dot{m}_{\mathrm{rem},N_{\mathrm{aer}}+1}(p_{\mathrm{in}}) - \max\left(10^{-9},\, 10^{-4}\dot{m}_{\mathrm{tube,in}}\right). \tag{192}$$

Within each marched segment, the local released mass flow is itself found from an inner scalar root because the Ergun backpressure depends on the unknown release rate. With

$$G_i(\dot{m}_{\mathrm{rel},i}) = C_d A_{h,\mathrm{seg}}\sqrt{2\rho_i \max(p_{\mathrm{tube},i} - p_{\mathrm{bed},i}(\dot{m}_{\mathrm{rel},i}), 0)} - \dot{m}_{\mathrm{rel},i},$$

the code brackets $\dot{m}_{\mathrm{rel},i} \in [0, \dot{m}_{\mathrm{rem},i}]$ and applies bounded bisection on that interval until the local discharge and the local porous-bed backpressure closure are mutually consistent. If the release implied by the local pressure difference exceeds the remaining segment inlet flow, the upper bound $\dot{m}_{\mathrm{rem},i}$ is accepted directly. The code starts from $p_{\mathrm{lo}} = 0$ and an initial high-side estimate based on the whole-hole-area discharge approximation described earlier. A pressure bracket is considered found when the marched state at the current upper bound satisfies

$$F(p_{\mathrm{hi}}) \leq 0,$$

because the low side still leaves too much flow at the cap while the high side releases enough mass that the terminal residual is within tolerance. The code therefore doubles $p_{\mathrm{hi}}$ until this condition is first met, then bisects on $p_{\mathrm{in}}$ within $[p_{\mathrm{lo}}, p_{\mathrm{hi}}]$ `heat_transfer_study.py:L2914-L2955`; `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L1895-L1946`. If no such upper bound is found within the configured doubling limit, the highest tried pressure state is returned as the best available unresolved case. Here $\dot{m}_{\mathrm{rem},N_{\mathrm{aer}}+1}$ should be interpreted as the numerical residual of a trial pressure march, not as a physical steady leakage through the sealed cap. A trial inlet pressure that is too low leaves positive residual flow after the last perforated segment because the guessed pressure field does not drive enough side release. A trial inlet pressure that is too high drives release too aggressively upstream and can deplete the branch early; because each segment release is clamped so it cannot exceed the remaining flow, the residual never becomes meaningfully negative. The accepted solution is therefore the *smallest* bracketed inlet pressure that satisfies the closed-end mass-balance tolerance, not an arbitrary overpressured state. For optimizer hygiene, the live Python summer workflow now records whether this inner pressure bracket was successfully found. Any summer point with an unresolved closed-end pressure solve is retained only for diagnostics and is automatically excluded from Pareto eligibility before NSGA-II ranking `heat_transfer_study.py:L2914-L2955`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L3531-L3588`. This prevents a bracket-failure edge case from contaminating the reported cooling Pareto set even though the unresolved point is still available for debugging output.

The summer branch closes the bed-reference temperature by solving the scalar consistency condition

$$R(T_{\mathrm{bed,ref}}) = \frac{T_b(T_{\mathrm{bed,ref}}) + T_t(T_{\mathrm{bed,ref}})}{2} - T_{\mathrm{bed,ref}} = 0, \tag{193}$$

where $T_b$ and $T_t$ are obtained from the two-node bed solve using the branch heat rate predicted at that trial reference temperature `heat_transfer_study.py:L2910-L2917`. If the lower and upper trial bounds bracket a sign change, the code applies bisection:

$$T_{\mathrm{mid}} = \frac{T_{\mathrm{lo}} + T_{\mathrm{hi}}}{2}, \tag{194}$$

updating the bracket by the sign of $R(T_{\mathrm{mid}})$ until either

$$|R(T_{\mathrm{mid}})| < 0.02 \qquad \text{or} \qquad |T_{\mathrm{hi}} - T_{\mathrm{lo}}| < 0.02, \tag{195}$$

otherwise the closer endpoint is retained `heat_transfer_study.py:L2918-L2947`. These are repository numerical constructs rather than textbook closed forms.

When the assist blower is enabled, the summer branch also closes the achieved airflow through the scalar residual (176). If the requested airflow already satisfies $R_{\dot{V}}(\dot{V}_{\mathrm{req}}) \leq 0$, that request is retained. Otherwise the code bisects over $[0, \dot{V}_{\mathrm{req}}]$, keeping the highest bracketed flow that still satisfies $R_{\dot{V}} \leq 0$, until the flow bracket is smaller than $10^{-6} \max(\dot{V}_{\mathrm{req}}, 1)$ in code units `heat_transfer_study.py:L2793-L2858`. The branch thermodynamics are then recomputed at that achieved flow before the cooling metrics are reported.

# 18 Annual climate and year-round operating layer

## 18.1 Climate anchors and regression baseline

The annual layer stores for each month $m$ a Connecticut monthly mean temperature $\bar{T}_m$ and monthly standard deviation $\sigma_m$ derived from the NOAA series described in `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L2576-L2616`. The representative-year ambient baseline uses circular Gaussian-kernel regression:

$$\hat{y}(d) = \frac{\sum_i w_i(d) y_i}{\sum_i w_i(d)}, \qquad w_i(d) = \exp\left[-\frac{1}{2}\left(\frac{\delta_i(d)}{h}\right)^2\right], \tag{196}$$

with wraparound day distance

$$\delta_i(d) = \min(|d - d_i|,\ P - |d - d_i|)\,. \tag{197}$$

This same periodic Gaussian regression is applied both to the monthly mean anchors and to the monthly standard-deviation anchors `heat_transfer_study.py:L4794-L4808`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L4866-L4879`.

## 18.2 Freeze-day allocation and anomaly override

Expected monthly freeze-day counts are converted to representative integer counts by largest-remainder allocation:

$$n_{f,m} = \mathrm{LR}(F_m). \tag{198}$$

Within each month, day-of-month weights are centered on the observed mean freeze day $\mu_{f,m}$:

$$w_{f,m}(i) = \exp\left[-\frac{(i - \mu_{f,m})^2}{2s_{f,m}^2}\right], \tag{199}$$

and sequential selection applies a repulsion modifier

$$\tilde{w}_{f,m}(i) = w_{f,m}(i) \prod_{j \in \mathcal{S}_{f,m}} \left[1 - 0.65 \exp\left(-\frac{(i-j)^2}{2r_{f,m}^2}\right)\right]. \tag{200}$$

On the selected freeze days, the ambient profile is overridden by

$$T_m(d) = \min\bigl(T_{\mathrm{base},m}(d),\, \bar{T}_m - \Delta T_{f,m}\bigr)\,. \tag{201}$$

These relations correspond to `heat_transfer_study.py:L4683-L4732`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L4893-L4906`.

## 18.3 Heat-wave allocation and anomaly override

Monthly spell starts and total heat-wave days are likewise allocated by largest-remainder rounding:

$$n_{s,m} = \mathrm{LR}(S_m), \qquad n_{h,m} = \mathrm{LR}(H_m). \tag{202}$$

The start-day weighting is

$$w_{h,m}(i) = \exp\left[-\frac{(i - \mu_{h,m})^2}{2s_{h,m}^2}\right], \tag{203}$$

with repulsion-modified score

$$\tilde{w}_{h,m}(i) = w_{h,m}(i) \prod_{j \in \mathcal{S}_{h,m}} \left[ 1 - 0.65 \exp\left( -\frac{(i-j)^2}{2r_{h,m}^2} \right) \right]. \tag{204}$$

Each selected heat-wave spell is forced to last at least three days in the code, and the ambient override is

$$T_m(d) = \max\big(T_m(d),\, \bar{T}_m + \Delta T_{h,m}\big)\,. \tag{205}$$

These relations correspond to `heat_transfer_study.py:L4735-L4791`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L4907-L4911`.

## 18.4 Daily heating and cooling loads

For each representative day $d$, the required heating and cooling loads are

$$Q_{\mathrm{req},h}(d) = UA_{\mathrm{bin}} \max(T_{h,\mathrm{set}} - T_\infty(d),\, 0)\,, \tag{206}$$

$$Q_{\mathrm{req},c}(d) = UA_{\mathrm{bin}} \max(T_\infty(d) - T_{c,\mathrm{set}},\, 0)\,, \tag{207}$$

which are implemented by rebuilding the bin model at the day's ambient and calling the same lumped-loss routine used elsewhere `heat_transfer_study.py:L4977-L4983`.

## 18.5 Reference-point capacity re-solve and duty application

The annual layer re-solves the selected heating and cooling operating points at each day's ambient temperature to obtain

$$Q_{h,\mathrm{cap}}(d) = Q_{\mathrm{to\,bed},h}(T_\infty(d))\,, \qquad P_{h,\mathrm{elec}}(d) = P_h(T_\infty(d))\,, \tag{208}$$

$$Q_{c,\mathrm{cap}}(d) = -Q_{\mathrm{to\,bed},c}(T_\infty(d))\,, \qquad P_{c,\mathrm{elec}}(d) = P_{\mathrm{spot\,cooler}}(d) + P_{\mathrm{assist\,blower}}(d). \tag{209}$$

The required duty fractions are

$$D_h^*(d) = \frac{Q_{\mathrm{req},h}(d)}{Q_{h,\mathrm{cap}}(d)}, \qquad D_c^*(d) = \frac{Q_{\mathrm{req},c}(d)}{Q_{c,\mathrm{cap}}(d)}, \tag{210}$$

and the applied duties are clipped at unity:

$$f_{\mathrm{day}} = \begin{cases} \min\left( \max\left( \dfrac{\dot{Q}_{\mathrm{load}}}{\dot{Q}_{\mathrm{nom}}}, 0 \right), 1 \right), & \dot{Q}_{\mathrm{nom}} > 0, \\ 0, & \dot{Q}_{\mathrm{nom}} = 0 \text{ and } \dot{Q}_{\mathrm{load}} \le 0, \\ 1, & \dot{Q}_{\mathrm{nom}} = 0 \text{ and } \dot{Q}_{\mathrm{load}} > 0, \end{cases} \tag{211}$$

which, in mode-specific notation, are exactly

$$D_h(d) = \min(\max(D_h^*(d), 0), 1), \qquad D_c(d) = \min(\max(D_c^*(d), 0), 1). \tag{212}$$

The applied bed load is therefore

$$Q_{\mathrm{bed}}(d) = \begin{cases} D_h(d)\, Q_{h,\mathrm{cap}}(d), & \text{heating day}, \\ -D_c(d)\, Q_{c,\mathrm{cap}}(d), & \text{cooling day}, \\ 0, & \text{idle day}. \end{cases} \tag{213}$$

### 18.6 Daily bed temperatures, electricity, cost, and water

The daily bed temperatures are obtained from the same two-node steady system:

$$\begin{bmatrix} UA_{b,\infty} + UA_{bt} & -UA_{bt} \\ -UA_{bt} & UA_{t,\infty} + UA_{bt} \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} T_b(d) \\ T_t(d) \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} f_b Q_{\text{bed}}(d) + UA_{b,\infty} T_\infty(d) \\ (1 - f_b) Q_{\text{bed}}(d) + UA_{t,\infty} T_\infty(d) \end{bmatrix}. \tag{214}$$

Daily heating and cooling electricity are

$$E_h(d) = \frac{P_{h,\text{elec}}(d)\, D_h(d)\, 24}{1000}, \qquad E_c(d) = \frac{P_{c,\text{elec}}(d)\, D_c(d)\, 24}{1000}, \tag{215}$$

so the total day electrical energy is

$$E_{\text{day}} = E_h(d) + E_c(d). \tag{216}$$

With electricity price $c_{\text{elec}}$, the daily cost is

$$C(d) = c_{\text{elec}} E_{\text{day}}, \tag{217}$$

and the daily water-replacement estimate is

$$m_{\text{water}}(d) = \dot{m}_{\text{water},24h}\, D(d), \tag{218}$$

where $D(d)$ is the active heating or cooling duty fraction for that day. These are repository numerical constructs driven by the same daily re-solved heating/cooling reference points `heat_transfer_study.py:L4966-L5072`.

## 19 Implementation notes and deviations from the written model

- The authoritative reported heating recommendation is now Python-side, even though MATLAB still generates the heating candidate physics. The rooted execution path therefore treats Python as the final recommendation authority `heat_transfer_study.py:L6908-L6947`; `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L536-L608`.
- Maximum bottom and top bed temperatures are enforced in the Python-side heating and cooling feasibility logic; the MATLAB helper `explicitlySafe(...)` still omits those maxima `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L2647-L2659`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L2220-L2368`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L2963-L3112`.
- Cooling selection is no longer lexicographic. The current code uses constrained NSGA-II plus a report-priority ordering inside the feasible cooling Pareto set `heat_transfer_study.py:L3148-L3208`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L6220-L6490`.
- Cooling shortfall is computed and printed, but not enforced as a hard cooling feasibility condition in the current NSGA-II implementation `heat_transfer_study.py:L2915-L2959`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L2963-L3112`.
- The post-cooler relative humidity used by the summer evaporation model is recomputed after psychrometric condensate removal, limited by any configured rated condensate capacity `heat_transfer_study.py:L2662-L2673`.
- The rooted refresh/export path disables MATLAB plotting and transients in the generated export helper, so the rooted execution graph exercises steady heating physics rather than the optional MATLAB transient branch `analyze_vermicomposter_heater.py:L294-L304`.

# 20 Symbol glossary with units

| Symbol | Meaning | Units |
|---|---|---|
| $A_h$ | area of one perforation hole | $\mathrm{m}^2$ |
| $A_{h,\mathrm{seg}}$ | total perforation area assigned to one aeration segment | $\mathrm{m}^2$ |
| $A_{\mathrm{bed,trib}}$ | tributary porous-bed flow area assigned to one aeration segment | $\mathrm{m}^2$ |
| $A_{\mathrm{wet}}$ | effective wetted area assigned to evaporation | $\mathrm{m}^2$ |
| $Bi$ | lumped-capacitance Biot number | 1 |
| $C_d$ | perforation discharge coefficient | 1 |
| $c_p$ | specific heat of air | $\mathrm{J\,kg^{-1}\,K^{-1}}$ |
| $d_{32}$ | Sauter mean diameter used in particle-area estimate | m |
| $d_p$ | representative particle diameter used in the Ergun porous-bed closure; defaults to $d_{32}$ unless overridden | m |
| $D_i, D_o$ | inner and outer tube diameters | m |
| $\varepsilon$ | bed porosity used in the Ergun porous-bed closure | 1 |
| $f$ | Darcy friction factor | 1 |
| $h$ | convective heat-transfer coefficient | $\mathrm{W\,m^{-2}\,K^{-1}}$ |
| $h_m$ | mass-transfer coefficient | $\mathrm{m\,s^{-1}}$ |
| $h_{fg}$ | latent heat of vaporization | $\mathrm{J\,kg^{-1}}$ |
| $I_{\mathrm{tot}}$ | total electrical current draw | A |
| $Nu, Re, Pr, Ra$ | standard dimensionless groups | 1 |
| $P_{\mathrm{tot}}$ | total electrical power | W |
| $Q_{\mathrm{bed,total}}$ | net total bed heat rate; negative in cooling mode | W |
| $Q_{\mathrm{cool}}$ | positive cooling capacity, $\max(-Q_{\mathrm{bed,total}}, 0)$ | W |
| $Q_{\mathrm{req}}$ | lumped required heating or cooling load | W |
| $T_b, T_t$ | bottom and top bed-node temperatures | °C |
| $T_\infty$ | ambient air temperature | °C |
| $UA$ | lumped conductance | $\mathrm{W\,K^{-1}}$ |
| $A_{\mathrm{vent,branch}}$ | total top-vent area assigned to one aeration branch in the outlet-boundary closure | $\mathrm{m}^2$ |
| $C_{d,\mathrm{vent}}$ | simple-hole vent discharge coefficient used by the outlet-boundary closure | 1 |
| $\Delta p_i$ | local tube-to-bed pressure difference driving perforation discharge | Pa |
| $L_{\mathrm{bed},i}$ | representative porous escape length attached to aeration segment $i$ | m |
| $p_{\mathrm{bed},i}$ | local bed-side gauge pressure adjacent to aeration segment $i$ | Pa |
| $p_{\mathrm{out,bnd}}$ | derived outlet-boundary gauge pressure at the end of the porous escape path | Pa |
| $p_{\mathrm{out,offset}}$ | configured outlet-boundary gauge offset or closed-top fallback pressure | Pa |
| $u_{h,i}$ | local mean hole exit velocity | $\mathrm{m\,s^{-1}}$ |
| $u_{\mathrm{bed},i}$ | superficial porous-bed velocity attached to aeration segment $i$ | $\mathrm{m\,s^{-1}}$ |
| $y_{\mathrm{tube,rep}}$ | representative tube-center height used by the porous-bed pressure model | m |
| $\phi_{\mathrm{rel},i}$ | fraction of inlet tube mass released by aeration segment $i$ | 1 |
| $\dot{m}_{\mathrm{evap}}$ | evaporation mass flow rate | $\mathrm{kg\,s^{-1}}$ |
| $\dot{V}_{\mathrm{tot}}$ | total imposed volumetric flow rate | $\mathrm{m^3\,s^{-1}}$ |

## 21 Bibliography / source notes


R1 Churchill, S.W.; Bernstein, M. "A Correlating Equation for Forced Convection From Gases and Liquids to a Circular Cylinder in Crossflow." *Journal of Heat Transfer* 99(2), 1977, pp. 300–306. An accessible scan was used to verify that the implemented overall correlation appears as equation (9) on p. 303. The repository stores the citation string at `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L4-L8`.

R2 Gnielinski, V. "New Equations for Heat and Mass Transfer in Turbulent Pipe and Channel Flow." *International Chemical Engineering* 16(2), 1976, pp. 359–368. The article page range was independently verifiable from accessible bibliographic records; the repository stores the citation string at `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L9-L10`.

R3 Churchill, S.W. "Friction-Factor Equation Spans All Fluid-Flow Regimes." *Chemical Engineering* 84(24), 1977, pp. 91–92. The repository stores the citation string at `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L11-L12`.

R4 Churchill, S.W.; Chu, H.H.S. "Correlating Equations for Laminar and Turbulent Free Convection from a Vertical Plate." *International Journal of Heat and Mass Transfer* 18(11), 1975, pp. 1323–1329. An accessible scan was used to verify that the implemented isothermal-wall relation appears as equation (9) on p. 1325. The repository stores the citation string at `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L13-L15`.

R5 The repository cites Bergman, Lavine, Incropera, and DeWitt generically for thermal resistances, developing internal flow, lumped balances, and free convection `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L16-L17`. Edition and page numbers are not stored in the repository.

R6 Idel'chik, I.E. *Handbook of Hydraulic Resistance*. The accessible English translation consulted online places the Section IV sudden-expansion discussion and the Borda–Carnot coefficient used here on p. 112. The repository source mapping for this usage is `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L2130-L2141`; `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L1976-L1984`.

R7 The helix geometry relation is documented as a repository-native design relation in comments and TeX narrative `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L1708-L1727`; `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L38-L121`.

R8 Towler, G.; Sinnott, R. *Chemical Engineering Design: Principles, Practice and Economics of Plant and Process Design*, 3rd ed. Butterworth-Heinemann, 2022. Chapter 15 restates the Frössling relation for single particles or droplets as equation (15.11), $Sh = 2.0 + 0.552Re^{0.5}Sc^{0.33}$, and that algebraic form is the direct source used here for the hole-scale mass-transfer surrogate.

R9 Wagner, W.; Pruss, A. "The IAPWS Formulation 1995 for the Thermodynamic Properties of Ordinary Water Substance for General and Scientific Use." *Journal of Physical and Chemical Reference Data* 31(2), 2002, pp. 387–535. Section 2.3.1 reproduces the auxiliary saturation relations used for vapor pressure and the saturated liquid and vapor densities, with the vapor-pressure equation at equation (2.5) on p. 399 and the density equations at equations (2.6)–(2.7) on p. 399; Section 2.3.2 gives the saturation-boundary enthalpy relations at equations (2.10)–(2.11) on p. 400. This is the same auxiliary saturation package that the paper notes had also appeared in the earlier supplementary-release lineage. In the current Python implementation, `IAPWS_95.py` supplies the saturation-pressure call, directly evaluates equations (2.6)–(2.7) for the saturated liquid and vapor densities, and then forms latent heat from Helmholtz-relation enthalpies evaluated at those saturation densities rather than by directly coding equations (2.10)–(2.11); the repository commentary using these relations is at `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L18-L36`; `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L1089-L1167`.

R10 Kloppers, J.C.; Kröger, D.G. "The Lewis factor and its influence on the performance prediction of wet-cooling towers." *International Journal of Thermal Sciences* 44(9), 2005, pp. 879–884. This

corrects the author names stored in some repository comments while preserving the same title and journal context. The repository narrative using the Lewis relation is at `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L1174-L1180`.

R11 Frederickson, J.; Howell, G.; Hobson, A.M. "Effect of pre-composting and vermicomposting on compost characteristics." *European Journal of Soil Biology* 43(S1), 2007, pp. S320–S326. Table 3 supplies the particle-size fractions used for the wetted-area estimate. The repository reproduces those fractions at `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L1015-L1088`.

R12 Idel'chik, I.E. *Handbook of Hydraulic Resistance.* The accessible English translation consulted online places the general incompressible orifice-discharge relation $Q = \mu F\sqrt{2\Delta p/\rho}$ at equation (1-48) on p. 31, the thin-wall simplification at equation (1-49) on p. 31, and representative discharge-coefficient values for orifices on p. 32; the same translation places the Section III contraction discussion on pp. 82–85 and equation (3-3), used here for the conical bellmouth contraction surrogate, on p. 83. The repository source mapping for these usages is `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L1895-L2076`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L2825-L2849`; `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L2148-L2232`; `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L1943-L1955`.

R13 Hausen, H. "Darstellung des Wärmeüberganges in Rohren durch verallgemeinerte Potenzbeziehungen." *Zeitschrift des VDI, Beiheft Verfahrenstechnik* 8(4), 1943, pp. 91–98. Later literature and thesis bibliographies preserve this citation; the repository uses the resulting Hausen-type form but does not currently store the primary citation string.

R14 Crowl, D.A.; Louvar, J.F. *Chemical Process Safety: Fundamentals with Applications*, 2nd ed. Prentice Hall, 2002. Section 4-4, "Flow of Liquids through Pipes," gives the 2-$K$ method used here for fitting-loss surrogates: equation (4-38) on p. 124, Table 4-2 on p. 125, and the entrance/exit modification at equation (4-39) on p. 126. The same p. 126 discussion below equation (4-40) notes that a simple hole has $\sum K_f = 1.5$, giving $C_d \approx 0.63$. The current repository uses those relations as reduced-order surrogates for the unresolved air-side header and splitter-body losses, with the optional header treated as a normal entrance, one splitter branch path treated as a standard threaded tee used as an elbow followed by one full-line open gate/ball/plug valve, and the vented-top outlet boundary treated as a simple-hole discharge.

R15 Ergun, S. "Fluid Flow Through Packed Columns." *Chemical Engineering Progress* 48(2), 1952, pp. 89–94. The current repository uses the standard Ergun packed-bed pressure-drop form as a segmentwise porous-bed backpressure surrogate between each aeration-segment release zone and the nearest top opening.

R16 Fornes, F.; Mendoza-Hernández, D.; García-de-la-Fuente, R.; Abad, M.; Belda, R.M. "Composting versus vermicomposting: A comparative study of organic matter evolution through straight and combined processes." *Bioresource Technology* 118, 2012, pp. 296–305. Table 2 on p. 299 reports total porosity for the composting (COM), vermicomposting (VER), and combined composting-plus-vermicomposting (C + V) stages. The current repository uses the COM day 21 and day 63 total-porosity values (80.1 and 79.9% v/v) as the bracketing measurements around the nominal 30-day pre-composting interval, giving the default constant $\varepsilon = 0.80$, and notes the weak variation of the C + V values over the later vermicomposting interval when justifying the constant-porosity simplification.

R17 Idel'chik, I.E. *Handbook of Hydraulic Resistance.* For the helical-coil obstruction discussion, the consulted scan was checked at the "Tubes with wire ribbing" entry in Section VIII (printed p. 337; PDF file page 346) and at "Spiral-ribbed air heater," Diagram 12-21, in Section XII (printed p. 482; PDF file page 491). The current repository does not transcribe either chart directly into one closed-form pressure-drop equation. Instead it uses them as source-backed evidence that internal ribbing contributes a finite added resistance beyond smooth-passage Darcy friction, and maps that effect

to the projected-area drag surrogate implemented in `heat_transfer_study.py:L4205-L4258`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L4478-L4509`.

- NOAA and EIA URLs used by the annual layer are preserved in the configuration and narrative, not in a dedicated bibliography database `HeatTransferStudy/VermiHeatLoss.tex:L2574-L3164`; `HeatTransferStudy/study_config.json:L289-L419`.

## Implementation topic map

| Concept | Governing equations and source status | Implementation mapping and notes |
|---|---|---|
| Tube flow, perforations, electrical grouping | Equations: `eq:volflow_per_tube`–`eq:electrical_totals`. Source status: repository bookkeeping plus [R12] for the closed-end perforation discharge relation. | Implementation: `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L763-L875`; `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L1497-L1677`. Notes: series-parallel grouping allowed. |
| Internal convection and friction | Equations: `eq:internal_laminar_nu`, `eq:internal_turbulent_nu`, `eq:churchill_friction_full`. Source status: [R2], [R3], [R5]. | Implementation: `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L2382-L2407`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L3755-L3774`. Notes: used in both heater and aeration branches. |
| Heater axial energy balance | Equations: `eq:heater_segment_air`, `eq:wire_delta_t`. Source status: [R1], [R5] plus repository discretization. | Implementation: `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L1803-L1894`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L3775-L3895`. Notes: explicit marching. |
| Aeration wall/jet/latent coupling | Equations: `eq:released_massflow`, `eq:aeration_remaining_mdot`, `eq:cooling_wall_factor`, `eq:aeration_q_jet`. Source status: [R5], [R12] plus repository reduction of sensible and latent paths. | Implementation: `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L1895-L2076`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L2987-L3277`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L4182-L4323`. Notes: same structure in heating and cooling. |
| Evaporation and latent heat | Equations: `eq:sauter_diameter`–`eq:evap_selected`. Source status: [R1], [R9], [R10], [R11]. | Implementation: `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L891-L937`; `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L2000-L2122`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L2567-L2603`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L3607-L3708`. Notes: minimum of three limiting rates. |

| Concept | Governing equations and source status | Implementation mapping and notes |
|---|---|---|
| Bin loss model and two-node bed | Equations: `eq:topmode_open`–`eq:two_node_split`. Source status: [R4], [R5] plus repository vented-cover extension. | Implementation: `vermicomposter_air_heater_design_model.m:L971-L1171`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L4326-L4438`. Notes: lumped bed closure. |
| Cooling spot cooler and assist blower | Equations: cooling and condensate relations in Sections 12–15. Source status: repository surrogate model. | Implementation: `heat_transfer_study.py:L2534-L3292`. Notes: includes condensate-limited RH update. |
| Heating and cooling NSGA-II | Equations: `eq:heating_constraint_residuals`–`eq:cooling_report_selection`. Source status: repository implementation. | Implementation: `heat_transfer_study.py:L51-L121`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L2181-L2499`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L3148-L3208`; `heat_transfer_study.py:L6220-L6490`. Notes: cooling now also NSGA-II. |
| Annual climate and duty layer | Equations: `eq:kernel_baseline`, `eq:daily_duty`, `eq:daily_energy`. Source status: repository numerical construct plus NOAA/EIA inputs. | Implementation: `heat_transfer_study.py:L4633-L5012`. Notes: not a literature first-principles climate model. |